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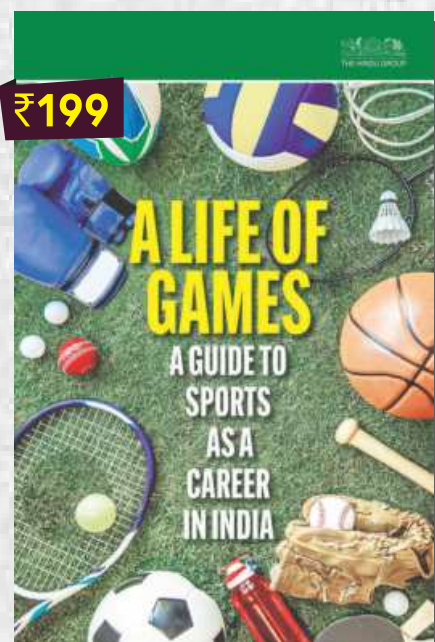
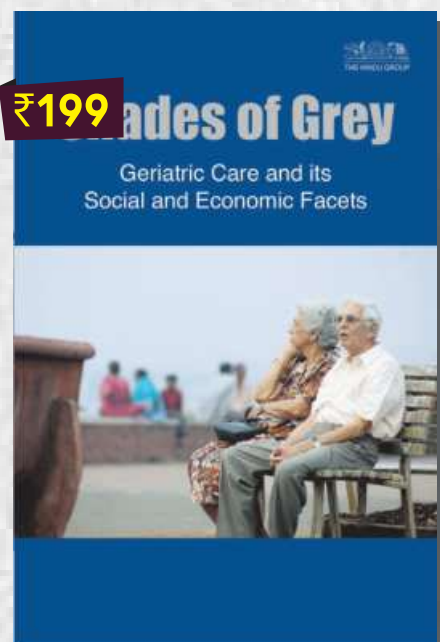
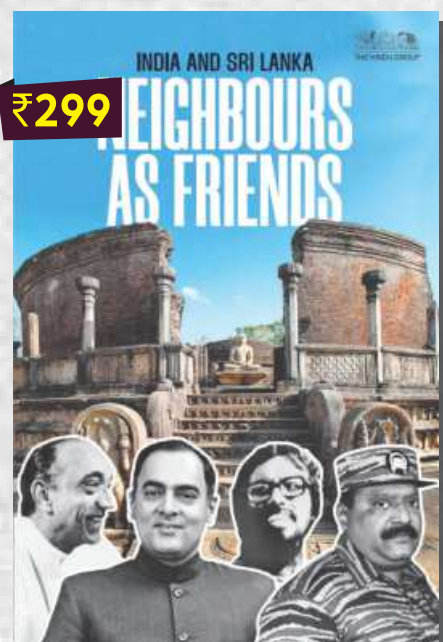
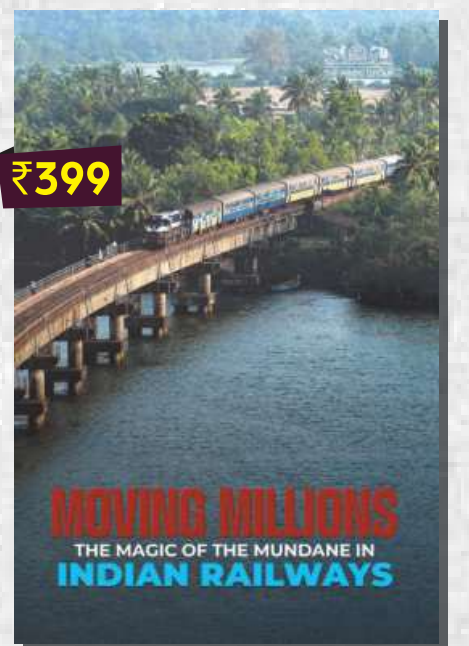
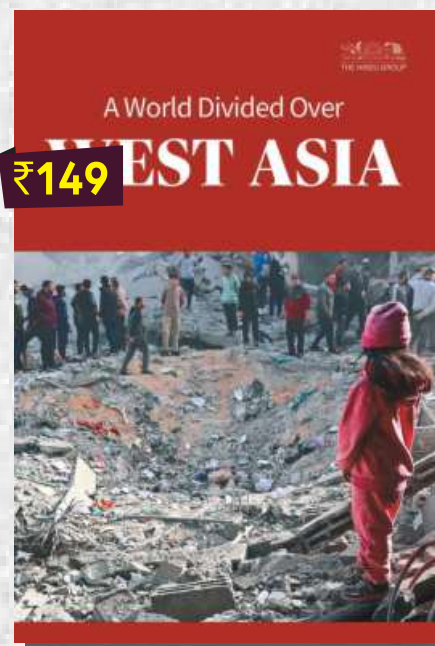
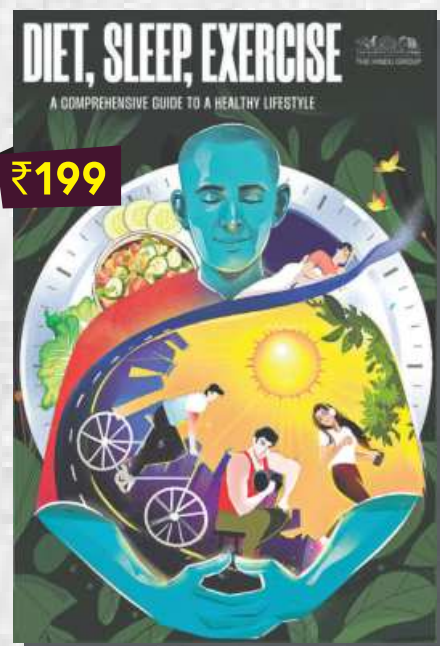
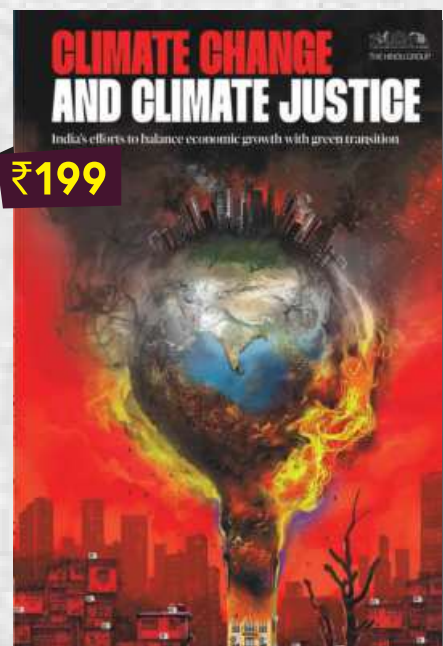
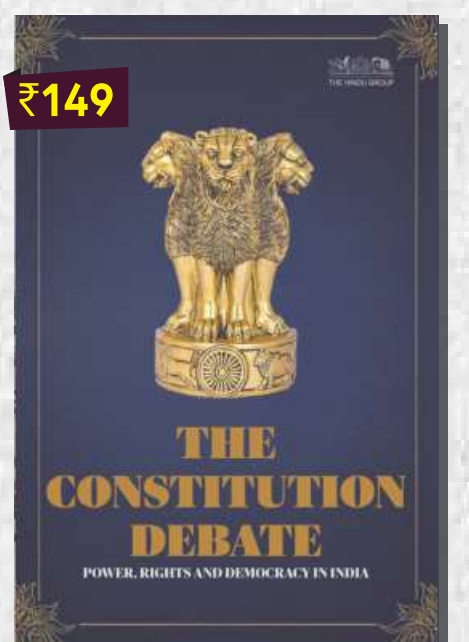
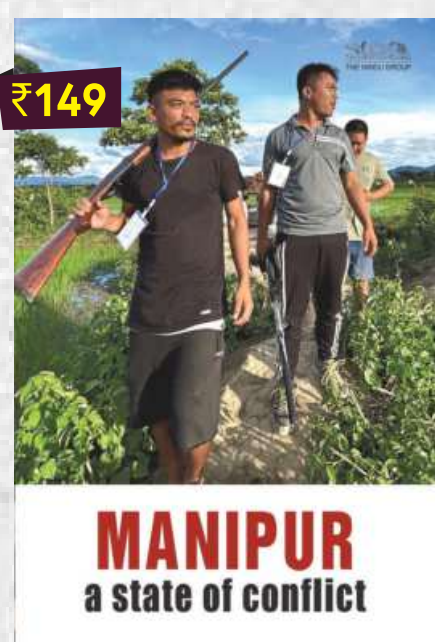
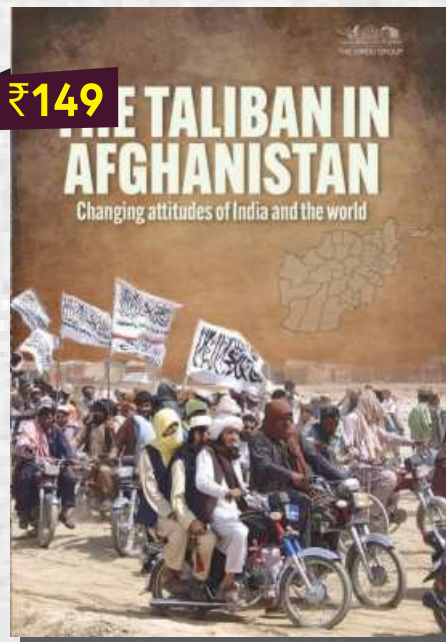
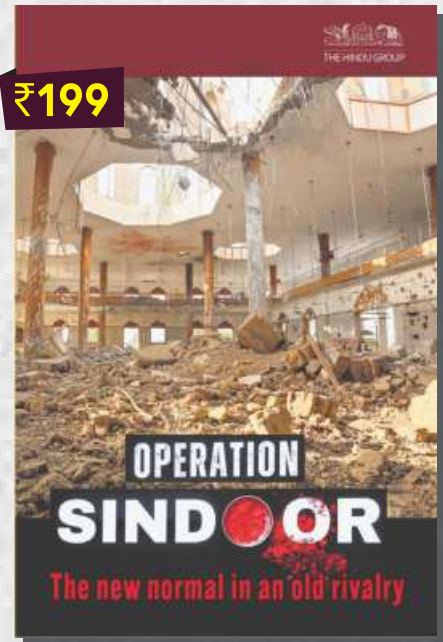
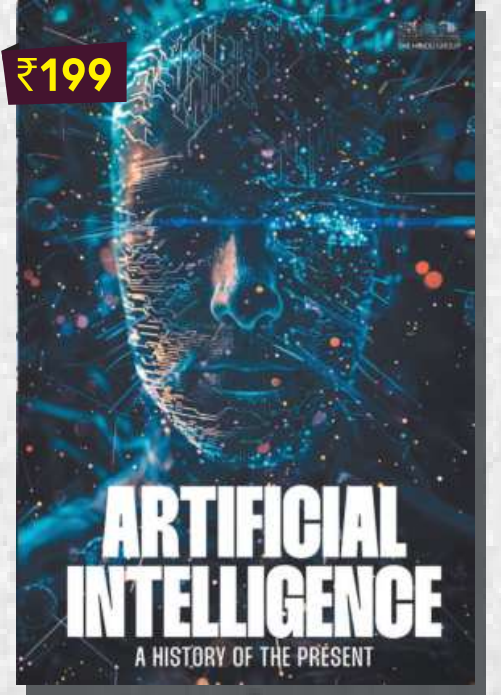




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📍 Indore	18 Aug 5:30 PM	24 अगस्त सुबह 8:00 बजे
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AAP'S DEMAND

Kejriwal warns of movement if E20 is not withdrawn

NEWS » PAGE 10

ONGOING DEMAND

***J&K's quest
for Statehood***

***Seven years after
abrogation of Article 370,
the wait is still on***

EDITORIAL » PAGE 6

RED SEA ATTACK

Indian-flagged ship sinks; 14 rescued

NEWS » PAGE 14

OPPORTUNITIES » PAGE 17

Udhayanidhi Stalin held for 'misogynist' remarks

DMK leader was released on bail at night as per direction of Madras HC; Udhayanidhi denies the charge, says he did not intend to hurt anyone; both DMK and TVK cadres hold protests across T.N.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI/THANJAVUR

Tamil Nadu's Leader of the Opposition and Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) youth wing leader Udhayanidhi Stalin was on Tuesday morning arrested by police following a complaint filed by a functionary of the ruling Tamilaga Vetttri Kazhagam (TVK) who accused him of making misogynist remarks at a public meeting in Thanjavur on Monday.

Mr. Udhayanidhi was taken to Thanjavur by road and questioned for nearly 90 minutes at the Sengipatti police station before being released on station bail at night as per a Madras High Court direction.

While DMK cadres protested across the State con-



T.N.'s Leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin waving after being released in Thanjavur on Tuesday. R. VENGADESH

blic speech in Thanjavur.

Denying the charges levelled against him, Mr. Udhayanidhi said he did not intend to hurt anyone, especially women, and that he did not engage in double entendre as alleged by some. He said that his speech has been misinterpreted out of context for political purposes. He accused the TVK of foisting the case to divert attention from the issues concerning farmers that he has been raising.

During the hearing of his anticipatory bail petition in the High Court, Advocate-General Vijay Narayan submitted that the police did not intend to remand Mr. Udhayanidhi in judicial custody.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

SC directs Centre to frame SOPs to curb 'digital arrest' scams

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday passed a detailed order directing the Centre, States, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and telecom authorities to prepare standard operating procedures (SOPs) to curb “digital arrest” scams.

The court directed them to operationalise mechanisms to redress grievances of victims, initiate criminal action through zero first information reports (FIRs) against cyber fraudsters, and restore the monetary losses of those defrauded in a time-bound manner.

The court referred to a status report submitted by the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) under the Ministry of Home Affairs, which stated that the complaints received on the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal against digital arrests have

Complaints against digital arrests dipped from 1,23,672 in 2024 to 58,249 in 2025, and stood at 16,377 for the period ending June 30, as per the Centre's report to the court

sharply reduced from 1,23,672 in 2024 to 58,249 in 2025, and stood at 16,377 for the period ending June 30, 2026.

However, the court said though the statistics were “certainly encouraging”, it was still essential to monitor the situation.

CONTINUED ON
» **PAGE 10**

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Over three lakh women register for Delhi Lakshmi Yojana so far

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Over 3 lakh women have registered for the Delhi Lakshmi Yojana, with more than 71,000 applications submitted through the portal, an official said on Tuesday.

According to the official, 3,00,709 registrations had been completed and 71,411 applications finally submitted on the portal as of 8 p.m. on Tuesday. On Monday, the portal recorded 2,29,167 registrations and 36,089 final applications by 9.30 p.m.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the online portal for the scheme on Saturday, under which eligible women will receive financial assistance of ₹2,500 per month.

According to the scheme guidelines, women aged between 21 and 60 years, whose annual family income is up to ₹2.5 lakh, are eligible to apply.

Women already receiving benefits under any other financial assistance scheme or pension, taxpayers, government employees, women with more than three living children, families with annual electricity consumption exceeding 2,400 units, and those owning four-wheelers are not eligible for the scheme.

Applicants must secure the recommendation of the MP or MLA of their constituency to apply for the scheme.

EC revises SIR deadline for the second time in a month

Distribution and collection of forms to continue until August 17 following a request from Delhi CEO; final roll now scheduled to be published on Oct. 27; 63.23% of 1.45 crore forms digitised so far

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

The Election Commission of India (EC) on Tuesday once again revised the schedule for the special intensive revision (SIR) of Delhi's electoral rolls, extending the ongoing door-to-door verification by Booth Level Officers (BLOs) till August 17 and postponing the publication of the final electoral roll to October 27.

This is the second such extension granted in a month after Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Ashok Kumar sought additional time, citing "slow progress of the enumeration process".

The distribution and collection of enumeration forms, which was initially scheduled to conclude within a month of the exercise beginning on June 30, was rescheduled to conclude on August 8 after the first extension announced by the EC on July 15.

According to data from



Voter verification Residents submitting documents for enumeration at a centre in Rajokri Pahadi, Mehrauli. SURUCHI KUMARI

the CEO's office, 63.23% of the 1.45 crore enumeration forms had been digitised as of Tuesday, while 99.199% forms were distributed, with just four days remaining for the completion of the first extension of the door-to-door verification.

'Slow progress'

"The office of the CEO has received reports of slow progress in the digitisation of enumeration forms. The proposal for an extension was then prepared and sent to the EC. The remaining time was not sufficient for the BLOs to complete

the exercise without errors and verify all details of the electors," a senior election official said.

During the ongoing enumeration phase, BLOs have been tasked with visiting households to distribute and collect filled enumeration forms containing details of electors and, wherever available, mapping them with the last SIR roll. They are also responsible for identifying absent, shifted, dead, and duplicate voters.

BLOs have reported challenges in verifying voters who have shifted out,

and helping electors map their details, or those of their relatives, with entries in previous rolls, the official said.

'Unbearable burden'

The official also said the extension was in line with recent Delhi High Court directions to ensure that election-related work does not place an unbearable burden on government school teachers deployed for the exercise.

"Some teachers are doing the SIR work after their regular school duties. By the time they come to the field, they are already exhausted. Though many have been relieved of school duties, that is not the case everywhere. The EC cannot impose this on schools," he said. The draft roll will now be published on August 24. Voters will be able to file their claims and objections from August 24-September 23, followed by a month-long notice period and disposal of claims.

'Mileage dropping, fuel cost must come down too': taxi drivers protest over E20

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Around 100 members of the Delhi Taxi, Tourist Transporters and Tour Operators Association held a protest in the national capital on Tuesday against the rollout of E20 (petrol blended with 20% ethanol). Members of the association raised concerns over reduced mileage, increased maintenance costs, and impact on older vehicles due to E20.

The association - Delhi's largest body of transporters, representing app-based vehicles, taxis, buses, autos, etc. - had originally planned a march to Jantar Mantar, but aborted it after being denied police permission.

They turned towards Rajghat, where a heavy police presence led to the march being called off.

Sanjay Samrat, the association president, said they submitted a detailed representation to Union Minister for Road Transport and



Union members gathering ahead of the aborted protest in New Delhi on Tuesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Highways Nitin Gadkari, seeking a review of the E20 fuel. While Mr. Gadkari had told Parliament on July 30 that E20 can reduce fuel economy by 2% to 6%, the association said older vehicles could see mileage losses of up to 20%, raising fuel costs and squeezing already thin margins.

'Double blow'

Baljinder Singh, a taxi service owner, said operators were facing a double blow from declining fuel efficiency and rising maintenance costs. "A vehicle that earlier ran 12-13 km per litre now

gives only 7-8 km, spiking our costs. We can't increase taxi fares due to intense competition," he said, adding that "if mileage is going down, so should the price of E20".

Titender Singh Bobby, who runs a tourist taxi service in south Delhi, echoed the concerns. "Vehicles built to run on petrol should continue to get petrol. The engine performance has deteriorated." He added that slower acceleration has left customers, especially tourists, dissatisfied, with some discontinuing the service.

NCSC told by HC to act on complaint against V-C's 'casteist' remarks: JNUSU

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court has directed the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) to act on a complaint filed by former

Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNU-SU) president Dhananjay against Vice-Chancellor Santishree Dhulipudi Pandit over her alleged casteist remarks made during a podcast interview earlier

this year, the students' union said on Tuesday.

The High Court has asked the NCSC "to decide the matter in a time-bound manner, preferably within the next eight weeks", a JNUSU statement read.

Contempt case: HC gives 4 weeks to AAP leaders

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday granted four weeks to Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leaders Arvind Kejriwal, Manish Sisodia, Sanjay Singh and others to respond to a criminal

contempt case initiated by Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma over their "vilifying" social media posts against her.

During the hearing, Mr. Kejriwal's counsel told a Bench of Justices Navin Chawla and Ravinder Dedeja that he had yet to re-

ceive the material forming the basis of the contempt case. Similar submissions were made by lawyers appearing for the other parties. The court asked the registry to supply the material to the respondents. It also granted four weeks to AAP leader Gopal Rai and

journalist Saurav Das to file their replies in a petition seeking contempt action against them for allegedly being part of an "orchestrated social media campaign" against Justice Sharma. The court posted the matter for further hearing on September 21.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

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Without prejudice, it is hereby informed to the general public at large that my client Shri Mohan Gopal S/o Late Shri Jai Gopal Gopal, aged about 57 years, R/o 4/4, GF, Block - 4, Roop Nagar, Delhi - 110007, has severed all the family ties and thereby has disinherited, disowned his Wife - Smt. Kiran Gopal Son - Shri Akshay Gopal and Daughter - Ms. Ayushi Gopal, along with their present & future descendants or legal heirs, permanently due to their consistent misconduct and past action or omissions against the family's honor, values & general wellbeing and thus they are hereby barred from the possibility of inheritance of any of the movable & immovable assets of my client with immediate effect. If anyone deals with any of them in any manner, do so at own risk, and consequences and my client shall not be responsible for any such acts and deeds thereof, after publication of this Notice.

Ashish Yadav, Advocate
5/123, GF, Pradhan Market, Nirankari Colony, Delhi-82

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the public at large that Mr. Ram Karan Singh is the allottee/owner of Flat No. 15/0803 on 6th Floor in Tower-15 admeasuring 2124 sq. ft., in the project "Spire Woods", situated at Sector-103, Gurgaon, Haryana. In the process of selling/transferring the aforesaid flat in the open market to a third party, it may please be noted that if any person has any claim, right, title, interest, lien, charge, objection or encumbrance of whatsoever nature in respect of the aforesaid flat or the proposed sale/transfer thereof, the same may be raised by filing written objections along with supporting documents before the undersigned within a period of 14 (fourteen) days from the date of publication of this notice, failing which it shall be presumed that no claim or objection exists, and the sale/transfer of the aforesaid flat shall be proceeded with accordingly.

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LEGAL NOTICE

FRESH PROCLAMATION OF SALE
(Under Order XXI Rule 66 CPC)

Activity	Timeline/ Date & Time
Date of Publication of Proclamation in Newspaper in English & Hindi as per Government Rules.	On or before 06.08.2026
The Sale Proclamation to be displayed on the Notice Board of Delhi High Court as well as District Court Complex, concerned SDM of the District of the Suit Property located, shall be affixed at conspicuous place in the presence of witness of locality and by beat of drums.	On or before 07.08.2026 between 10:00 AM to 02:00 PM
Date of Return of Publication	10.08.2026
Date & Time of Inspection of the Suit Property by the prospective buyers	On 18.08.2026, 19.08.2026, 20.08.2026 between 11:00 AM to 04:00 PM
Date & Time of Inspection of the Documents of the Suit Property	On 24.08.2026 between 11:00 AM to 02:00 PM
Date of Sale (by the Public Auction by the Court Auctioneer of the Suit Property)	On 02.09.2026 from 11:00 AM to 03:00 PM
Place of Public Auction	Suit Property itself
Date of Return of Proclamation	On or before 10.09.2026
Filing of Report before the Court	On or before 20.09.2026

PROCLAMATION OF SALE
(Under Order XXI Rule 66 of CPC)
IN THE HIGH COURT OF DELHI AT NEW DELHI
(ORDINARY ORIGINAL CIVIL JURISDICTION)
Execution Petition No. 58 of 2023
(Arising out of Judgment & Decree dated 03.03.2019 & 10.03.2022 respectively passed in CS(OS) No. 5442/018)
Jyanti Kumar Bhat S/o Late Shri N.S. Bhat, R/o T-2, 1003, Laxmi Heights, Sector CH-3, Greater Noida-201303 (U.P.)
Mob: 9910343146, Email: jkbhat0402@gmail.com
Deven Singh Bhat S/o Late Shri S. Sarajay Kumar Bhat, R/o Saray, Sai Gardens, Badli, Bangalore-560067 (Karnataka) Mob: 7022266075, Email: dvn.deven@gmail.com ... Decree Holders

Vis
Dhananjay Bhat S/o Late Shri N.S. Bhat, R/o Mayilla Cottage, Mayilla Compound, Tallah, Bangalore-280011 (Uttarahand) Mob: 8126118614, ... Judgment Debtor
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that, under Rule 66 of Order XXI of the Code of Civil Procedure, 1908, the orders dated 30.05.2026 & 06.07.2026 have been passed by this Hon'ble Court for the sale of the immovable property bearing No. Flat 2C, Second Floor, Vandana Building, 11, Tolstoy Marg, New Delhi in satisfaction of the claim of the creditors relating out of the execution relating out of Judgment & Decree dated 20.03.2019 & 10.03.2022 respectively passed in CS(OS) No. 5442/018.

The reserve price of the property is fixed at Rs. 1,08,64,380/- (Rupees One Crore Eight Lakh Sixty-Four Thousand Nine Hundred Eighty Only), as per the order of the Hon'ble Court.
The sale of the property bearing No. Flat 2C, Second Floor, Vandana Building, 11, Tolstoy Marg, New Delhi will be held by Public auction on 02.09.2026 from 11:00 A.M. to 03:00 P.M. the sale shall be conducted by Ms. Kumari Renu Chauhan, Court Appointed Court Auctioneer at the suit property or the liabilities and claims attaching to the suit property, so far as they have been ascertained, are those specified in Annexure 'A'.
In the absence of any order of the postponement, the sale of the property will be held by Public auction on 02.09.2026 from 11:00 A.M. to 03:00 P.M. by the Court Auctioneer.
The sale of the property shall be subject to its confirmation by the Hon'ble Delhi High Court.

CONDITIONS OF SALE
The sale of property shall be subject to usual terms and conditions mentioned in relevant rules of Order XXI, including Rule 82 to 96 and including but not limited to the following:-
The particulars specified in the Schedule below have been read to the best of the information of the Court, but the Court will not be answerable for any error, misstatement or omission in the proclamation.
1. The sale of the property will be in one lot. The property is being sold on "as is where is" basis. The amount by which the bidder is to be bound to pay the purchase price shall be the highest bid when the price offered appears so clearly inadequate as to make it inadvisable to do so.
2. The interested participant/bidder shall deposit an Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price in the form of a Bank Demand Draft drawn in favour of the Registrar General, Delhi High Court and shall hand over the same physically to the Court Auctioneer before the auction date. The Demand Drafts shall be returned to the unsuccessful participants on the same day after conclusion of the auction.
3. The person declared to be purchaser shall deposit 15% of the highest auction price through Demand Draft/Cheque in the name of the Registrar General, Delhi High Court on the same day after conclusion of the auction with the Court Auctioneer. The balance amount of the purchase money (i.e. the amount remaining after deducting the 15% deposited by the participant by way of Demand Draft of the reserve price + 15% of the amount of the highest auction price) shall be deposited by the purchaser with the Registrar General, Delhi High Court within three days.
4. In default of payment of the balance of purchase-money within the period allowed the deposit, after defraying the expenses, of the sale, the Court thinks fit, be forfeited and the defaulting purchaser shall forfeit all claims to the property or to any part of the sum for which it may be subsequently sold. The proposed buyer must satisfy himself regarding the title/document/property before bidding.
5. In default of payment of the balance of purchase-money within the period allowed the property shall be resold after the issue of a fresh notification of sale.
6. For reasons recorded, it shall be in the discretion of the officer conducting the sale to adjourn it subject always to the provisions of Rule 88 of Order XXI.
Given under my hand and the Seal of this Court, in terms of order dated 30.05.2026 & 06.07.2026.
For Further details, contact:
Ms. Kumari Renu Chauhan Deputy Registrar (ERO)
Court Appointed Auctioneer For REGISTRAR GENERAL, HIGH COURT OF DELHI
Contact no: 011-26107059
Email: renuchauhan7@gmail.com

North Eastern Railway

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"Open Tenders" through Online (E-Tendering) are invited by Divisional Railway Manager (Signal & Telecomm)/Varanasi/N.E. Railway for and behalf of the President of India for the following works: **Tender Notice No.: NER-BSBOST-OT-41-2026: Name of work:** Replacement of overaged Railway Telephone exchange with Asterisk based IP Exchange at DRM office in BSB division. **Approx. Value:** ₹ 38042221.37 **Earnest Money:** ₹ 760900.00 **Cost of Tender Form :** Rs. 00.00 **Completion period :** 180 Days **Tender Closing date & Time :** 24.08.2026 Upto 15.00 Hrs. **Note :** (1) Tender Online will be submitted up to 15 Hrs. on date 24.08.2026 (2) For full details and submission of bid kindly visit the Official website of Indian railways i.e. www.irops.gov.in **Divt. Rly. Manager (S&T) Varanasi**
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कोई भी पात्र व्यक्ति अपना नाम मतदाता सूची में शामिल करवाने के लिए फॉर्म 6 भर सकता है।

कौन फॉर्म 6 भर सकता है ?

जिनकी आयु 18 वर्ष या उससे अधिक हो गई है
01.07.2026 के अनुसार
जिन मतदाताओं की आयु 01 जुलाई, 2026 को 18 वर्ष या उससे अधिक हो चुकी है, वे फॉर्म 6 भरकर मतदाता सूची में अपना नाम जुड़वा सकते हैं।

जिन्होंने SIR के दौरान अपना एन्यूमरेशन फॉर्म जमा नहीं किया
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गैर हाजिर मतदाता (Absentee Voter)
जो मतदाता सेवा, व्यवसाय, शिक्षा या अन्य कारणों से अपने मतदाता क्षेत्र से बाहर रहते हैं, वे फॉर्म 6 भरकर अपना नाम मतदाता सूची में शामिल करवा सकते हैं।

स्थायी रूप से स्थानांतरित हो चुके मतदाता
जो मतदाता स्थायी रूप से एक स्थान से दूसरे स्थान पर चले गए हैं, वे अपने नए निवासी स्थान की मतदाता सूची में नाम जुड़वाने के लिए फॉर्म 6 भरें।

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Dwarka Golf Course lifetime memberships sold out: DDA

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has received 856 applications for 850 lifetime memberships of the Dwarka Golf Course within 11 days of the scheme's launch, the authority said in a statement on Tuesday.

Of the total, the non-government category has exceeded its quota, with 636 applications for 600 memberships. In the government category, 220 applications have been received against 250 memberships. Registrations will remain open until September 20.

Both categories are likely to be oversubscribed by the close of the registration period, the DDA said.

Applicants can register online by paying a non-refundable fee of ₹2,500, the DDA said. If applications exceed the number of memberships available in any category, allotments will be made through a computerised draw of lots after the registration period closes.

The authority is offering 850 lifetime memberships - 600 in the non-government category and 250 in the government category.

Membership fees are ₹7.5 lakh for non-government applicants and ₹3.5 lakh for government applicants. Three-year and five-year membership options are also currently available. The 18-hole Dwarka Golf Course, inaugurated in 2024, is spread across 158 acres in Sector 24, Dwarka.

The facility includes a 375-yard driving range, a clubhouse, a restaurant, a swimming pool, a pro shop, and other recreational amenities.

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INBRIEF



Uproar over comment on
madrasas by U.P. Deputy CM

A statement by Uttar Pradesh Deputy CM Keshav Prasad Maurya on Tuesday on madrasas sparked uproar, with the Opposition alleging that it was aimed at communal polarisation. Speaking at the Vidhan Bhavan, Mr. Maurya had said, “Those who receive a madrasa education neither chant ‘Bharat Mata ki Jai’ nor sing ‘Vande Mataram’; instead, they develop a terrorist-like mindset.” The Jamiat Ulama-i-Hind called the remarks “provocative, prejudiced and a deliberate attempt to undermine social harmony”. Congress leader Shah Nawaz Alam said such statements would become routine as the Assembly election approaches.

Court summons Pappu Yadav
over temple donation skit

A court in Prayagraj on Tuesday took cognisance of a criminal complaint against Independent MP Rajesh Ranjan, alias Pappu Yadav, over his skit at the Parliament complex highlighting the alleged theft of donations at the Ram Temple, and directed him to appear on August 11. The complaint was filed before the Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Prayagraj, by the co-convenor of BJP’s legal cell in Uttar Pradesh, Sushil Kumar Mishra. According to the complainant, the Purnea MP, dressed as a Hindu seer, enacted a scene depicting the alleged misappropriation of temple offerings.

M.P. BJP forms two-member
panel to review Datia bypoll
defeat, dissolves local unit

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

The Madhya Pradesh Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Tuesday evening disbanded its Datia district unit as part of disciplinary action following recommendations from a two-member review panel constituted earlier in the day to delve into the reasons for the Datia byelection loss. “On the directions of State president Hemant Khandelwal, and based on the recommendations of the committee constituted to review the results of the Datia Assembly by-election, the current organizational structure of the Bharatiya Janata Party, Datia District, is dissolved with immediate effect,” the party stated in an order. The two-member panel of M.P. BJP general secretary Gaurav Randeve and

The result has
fuelled rumours of
conflict within the
BJP and allegations
of internal sabotage

senior leader Ambaram Karada has been tasked with holding discussions with leaders and workers involved with the bypoll preparations and analysing the result. The committee was set up shortly after a meeting of senior leaders at Chief Minister Mohan Yadav’s residence in Bhopal. It was attended by Mr. Khandelwal, Deputy Chief Ministers Jagdish Devda and Rajendra Shukla, Datia candidate Ashutosh Tiwari, bypoll in-charge Bharat Singh Kushwaha, and other senior leaders and Ministers. Mr. Tiwari’s 6,016-vote

defeat at the hands of Congress candidate Ghanashyam Singh has fuelled rumours of conflict within the BJP and allegations of internal sabotage by supporters of former State Home Minister Narottam Mishra, who was denied a ticket from the seat that he has represented thrice. Accepting the mandate on Monday, Mr. Khandelwal also hinted, without taking any names, at action against those who may have worked against the party’s interests. ‘Find betrayers’ “First, we have to find out who the betrayer is,” Mr. Tiwari told reporters on a question about internal sabotage. A source in the State BJP unit said the meeting at the Chief Minister’s residence was “largely focused on allegations of sabotage”.

Channi’s options shrink as Congress refuses to budge in Punjab

NEWS ANALYSIS

Vikas Vasudeva
CHANDIGARH

Less than a year before the Punjab Assembly election, Congress leader Charanjit Singh Channi finds himself in a difficult position after locking horns with the party leadership over the recent organisation overhaul. With the party leadership clearly in no mood to relent, Mr. Channi’s options seem to have narrowed to two alternatives – accept a diminished role within the party or seek a political future elsewhere – neither of which may be favourable for him. The discord was triggered by the All India Congress Committee’s organisational overhaul on July 1. While Amrinder Singh Raja Warring was retained as



Charanjit Singh Channi, Congress’s most prominent Dalit face in the State, may have to accept a diminished role in the party. FILE PHOTO

the State unit chief, Mr. Channi, Punjab’s first Dalit Chief Minister, was appointed chairman of the State poll campaign panel. On July 3, the Lok Sabha member from Jalandhar and Congress’s most prominent Dalit face in the State convened a meeting of supporters at his Morinda residence, followed by another gathering in Mohali, in a clear show of

strength aimed at persuading the high command to revisit its decision. He was conspicuous by his absence from an event last week, where Congress general secretary for Punjab Bhupesh Baghel kicked off a nine-day mass mobilisation programme. He has stayed away from party events so far. While Mr. Baghel has repeatedly ruled out replac-

ing Mr. Warring as the Punjab Congress president, the faction led by the former CM has shown little sign of backing down. Disruptions during the party’s ‘Har Booth Mazboot’ events in Patiala, Samana and Bathinda, where sections of workers were seen raising slogans in Mr. Channi’s support, have publicly exposed the fault lines. Mr. Baghel’s warning – urging party workers to stay alert against “traitors within the party who could cause serious damage” – seems to have had little effect in calming tempers. Along with Mr. Channi, leaders such as Sukhjinder Singh Randhawa and Rana Gurjit are also believed to be upset with the revamp of the party unit, even as veteran leader Partap Singh Bajwa, the Leader of the Opposition in the State, is pushing for party unity

to wrest power from the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP). Weighing options “It appears that Congress factions are weighing their options and trying to outwit each other to gain a political edge. No faction can afford to go it alone. That would be self-destructive. But, if the situation fails to improve, I believe Channi could contest the election separately with leaders from his camp,” said Kehar Singh, former head of the Department of Political Science at Punjabi University. While Punjab Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) chief Kewal Dhillon has said he would welcome the Jalandhar MP into the party, Mr. Kehar feels the chances of disgruntled leaders switching to the BJP are slim. In January, Mr. Channi, who was also the party’s

chief ministerial face in the previous poll in which the Congress suffered a crushing defeat, called for “greater Dalit representation” in the party, adding that the community is “not getting due representation”. Dalit representation His remark, which brought the internal discord within the Congress into public, assumed significance given that Dalits constitute nearly 32% of Punjab’s population – the highest proportion among Indian States – making them a decisive electoral constituency. For the Congress, which had been emerging as a serious contender for the 2027 election, the continuing drama could result in loss of momentum. The infighting has, at least for now, shifted attention from its campaign against AAP towards its own infighting.

‘End harassment’: CPI MP
asks Modi to withdraw all
cases against protesters

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

CPI’s Rajya Sabha member P. Sandosh Kumar has written to Prime Minister Narendra Modi demanding an end to the “systematic harassment and intimidation” of students who participated in the stir against the NEET paper leak. Calling the protest a genuine expression of the frustration of students, he said participants in the movement are being subjected to intimidation by RSS workers and BJP leaders and demanded that all cases against students be withdrawn. Mr. Kumar said students who had documented the protests through social media content were threa-



CPI MP P. Sandosh Kumar

tened in the national capital while others faced harassment at their homes and their families also came under social pressure. “The youth exercised their democratic right to protest against injustice. They are now being subjected to intimidation and fear,” he said.

INBRIEF



Farmer trampled to death by elephants near A.P.-T.N. border

A farmer, resident of Chinna Matarlapalle village in Krishnagiri district, was trampled to death by a herd of six wild elephants near the Andhra Pradesh-Tamil Nadu border on Monday night, setting off protests in Krishnagiri district of Tamil Nadu. On the Chittoor side, farmers are staying out of their fields, unsure where the herd will move next. The village is barely 12 km from Kuppam, and the herd has been criss-crossing the contiguous forest along the inter-State border for several days.

Telangana govt. offices to get Internet services from T-Fiber

From September 1, Telangana government would not make payments for Internet service provided by private operators to government offices. IT Minister D. Sridhar Babu directed officials to ensure all of the offices receive Internet services exclusively through T-Fiber. The migration from Telangana State Wide Area Network (T-SWAN) to T-Fiber has to be completed in a month, the Minister said.

Kerala HC grants bail to four held for attack on ED officials

The Kerala High Court on Tuesday allowed the bail petitions of four more accused in the attack on Enforcement Directorate (ED) officials during a raid on former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan's residence in May. The court had allowed the petitions noting that the accused had spent more than 60 days in custody. Justice Kauser Edappagath allowed the bail, imposing the same conditions as on the bail applications of the nine accused who were granted bail on Monday.

Karnataka receives 29% deficit rainfall

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka has received a -29% southwest monsoon rainfall departure between June 1 and August 4. With several parts of the State receiving heavy rainfall in recent days, the first four days of August recorded 49 mm of rainfall against the normal 35 mm, with a departure of +39%.

According to data from the Karnataka State Natural Disaster Management Authority (KSDMA), the State recorded 357 mm of rainfall against the normal 506 mm between June 1 and August 4, representing a departure of -28%.

In June, the State recorded 116 mm of rainfall against the normal 199 mm, with a departure of -42%.

In July, it received 192 mm of rainfall against the normal 271 mm, with a departure of -29%.

While the rainfall in June was classified under the deficit category, July was classified under the normal category. However, KSDMA said the cumulative rainfall received between June 1 and August 4 falls under the deficit category.

Kerala to put in place disaster resilience system: Satheesan

Chief Minister reviews flood-relief operations, links worsening flood situation to declining carrying capacity of rivers; orange alert issued for nine districts; rain-related toll rises to 25 in past four days

The Hindu Bureau
PATHANAMTHITTA

Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan announced on Tuesday that Kerala will establish a state-of-the-art disaster resilience system in Pathanamthitta on a pilot basis to strengthen preparedness against recurring floods.

Reviewing the flood-relief operations in the district, which has been battered by severe flooding for the last four days, Mr. Satheesan said the proposed system would include a denser network of rain gauges and an advanced early warning mechanism to be developed in association with climate research



Clearing path: Machinery deployed to remove debris at the site of a landslide in Panakkad, Malappuram district. SAKEER HUSSAIN

institutions such as the Cochin University of Science and Technology (Cusat) and the Hume Centre.

Death toll in rain-related incidents over the past four days has risen to 25 while four people remain missing. Although the intensity of the rain has sub-

sided, the State is bracing for another round of intense spells by this weekend, aided by the low-pressure area over the Bay of Bengal.

An orange alert warning of intense heavy rain has been issued for nine districts on Wednesday.

“The challenge in Pathanamthitta is the increasing frequency of extreme rainfall events and cloudbursts. They leave us with very little time to respond and evacuate people safely,” he said, adding that reports had been received of a major landslide and several minor landslips inside forest areas.

The Chief Minister also linked the worsening flood situation to the declining carrying capacity of rivers. “We have not paid adequate attention to maintaining the carrying capacity of our rivers despite repeated floods since 2018. Once the floodwaters recede, our priority will be to de-silt the rivers and restore their carrying capacity,” he said.

Ex-MLA, son arrested

The Hindu Bureau
ELURU

Andhra Pradesh Police have arrested former Guntur East MLA Mohammad Mustafa and his son Mubashir, alias Bashir, on kidnapping and extortion charges. Mr. Mubashir was arrested by the police at the Hyderabad airport upon his arrival on Tuesday.

Mr. Mustafa had been traced and arrested at Vadodara on Monday night.

Rebel MLAs continue protests in Karnataka

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Dissent within the ruling Congress over the Karnataka Cabinet expansion continued for a second day on Tuesday, with senior MLAs expressing disappointment over being denied ministerial berths.

Supporters of MLAs Dinesh Gundu Rao, M. Krishnappa, Priya Krishna, and N.A. Harris gathered outside the party office in Ben-

galuru, demanding an explanation from Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar. Similar protests were reported from several constituencies. Meanwhile, Mr. Shivakumar warned that the resignations of disgruntled legislators would be accepted if they chose to quit.

Several party members alleged that their loyalty to former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah had become a reason for their exclusion.



Dr. B. R. AMBEDKAR UNIVERSITY DELHI
(Established by the Act of Legislative Assembly of National Capital Territory of Delhi)

RECRUITMENT NOTICE FOR TEACHING POSTS

No. AUD/55-1(67)/Rect./2026/838

Dated: 31.07.2026

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar University Delhi is a State University established through an Act by the Legislature of the National Capital Territory of Delhi invites online applications from the eligible candidates for the faculty positions (Professor, Associate Professor and Assistant Professor) on regular basis as detailed below:

S. No.	School	Discipline	Professor (Pay Level-14)	Associate Professor (Pay Level-13A)	Assistant Professor (Pay Level -10)
1.	School of Culture and Creative Expressions	Performing Arts/Performance Studies	01 (OBC-01)		
		Visual Arts		01 (ST-01)	01 (UR-01)
2.	School of Design	Design	01 (SC-01)	01 (OBC-01)	
3.	School of Development Studies	Development Studies	-	02 (OBC-01 & UR-01)	
4.	School of Global Affairs	Urban Studies		01(EWS-01)	
		Social Sciences		02(OBC-01 & EWS-01)	
5.	School of Public Policy & Governance	Public Policy and Governance	01(SC-01)	01(UR-01)	01 (UR-01)
		Public Health		01(UR-01)	02 (UR-01 & OBC - 01)
6.	School of Human Ecology	Development Studies/Ecology/ Environmental Studies/	02 (ST-01 & UR-01)		
7.	School of Human Studies	Gender Studies		01 (OBC-01)	
8.	School of Legal and Socio-Political Studies	Law or Any Social Science/ Humanities Discipline	01(OBC-01)	01 (SC-01)	02 (UR-01 & OBC-01)
		Crimonology and allied disciplines	01 (OBC-01)	01 (UR-01)	03 (UR-01, EWS-01 & OBC-01)
9.	School of Letters	Hindi	01(UR-01)	02(OBC-01 & ST-01)	05 (UR-02, EWS-01, OBC-01 & ST-01)
10.	School of Management	Management	02 (UR-01 & OBC-01)	02 (SC-01 & OBC-01)	07 (UR-02, EWS-01, OBC-01, SC-01 & ST-02)
11.	School of Undergraduate Studies	History	01(OBC-01)	01 (EWS-01)	
		Psychology	02 (OBC-01 & UR-01)	02 (OBC-01 & UR-01)	02 (UR-01 & SC-01)
		Social Science and Humanities		01 (OBC-01)	
		English	01 (OBC-01)		
		Sociology	02 (EWS-01 & UR-01)	01 (OBC-01)	
		Political Science		02 (UR-01 & EWS-01)	
12.	School of Vocational Studies	Vocational Studies (Retail Management/ Accounting & Finance/Tourism & Hospitality/Early Childhood Education)	03 (ST-01, OBC-01 & UR-01)	02 (SC-01 & EWS-01)	04 (UR-01, EWS-01, SC-01 & OBC-01)
13.	School of Heritage Research & Management	Archaeology/conservation and Museology	01 (OBC-01)	01(OBC-01)	02 (UR-01 & OBC-01)
14.	School of Education Studies	Education	04(EWS-01, OBC-01, UR-01 & SC-01)	02(OBC-01 & UR-01)	
		Liberal Discipline Pedagogy - Hindi			01 (UR-01)
		Leberal Discipline Pedagogy - English			01 (OBC-01)
		Liberal Discipline Pedagogy - History			01 (ST-01)
		Liberal Discipline Pedagogy - Geography			01 (OBC-01)
		Liberal Discipline Pedagogy - Political Science			01 (EWS-01)
		Liberal Discipline Pedagogy - Economics			02 (UR-01, OBC-01)
		Early Childhood Care and Education			01 (OBC-01)
Total			24	28	37

Note:

- Out of total 89 posts. 02 posts are horizontally reserved for Persons with Benchmark Disabilities (PwBD) under various categories as mentioned in the DoPT OM No.36035/02/2017-Estt (Res) dated 15.01.2018.
- For Qualifications,Eligibility Criteria, General Instructions, Online Application Form, Payment of Fee & other details, please visit University website https://aud.delhi.gov.in
- Hard copy of the application in form of prnitout of online application submitted by the candidate along with self-attested required documents, mentioning the name of the post/discipline and advertisement number on the top of the envelope, must reach at the following address:
Deputy Registrar (Recruitment & Promotion Cell), Room No. 31A, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar University Delhi, Lothian Road, Kashmere Gate Campus, Delhi - 110006
- The online applications will commence after publication of this advertisement in "Employment News".
- The Last date to apply online is three (03) weeks from the date of publication of this advertisement in "Employment News".
- The Last date of receiving applications in hard copy form is four (04) weeks from the date of publication of this advertisement in "Employment News".

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Directorate of Higher Education, Govt. of NCT of Delhi

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0164/26-27



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Notice for Invitation of Applications for Third Party Auditors

Applications are hereby invited from the eligible Third-Party Auditors for their registration and empanelment with Principal Director of Delhi Fire Service as Fire Safety Auditor (Third Party).

In pursuance of the provisions contained in Delhi Fire Service (Amendment) Rule 2025, "Fire Safety Auditors" as specified in rule - (iv-a) read with Rule 35, 36, 37 and 38 of the said rules are authorised to issue Forms H, I, J and K for compliance of the provisions contained in these Rules.

The eligible and qualified persons or association of persons or companies are hereby informed to apply on Form "U" (<https://dfs.delhi.gov.in/dfs/forms>) along with all requisite and mandatory documents on e-mail id director.dlfire@nic.in to the Principal Director, Delhi Fire Service for their registration / empanelment to act as a Fire Safety Auditors categorically mentioning the subject as "Application for registration / empanelment as Fire Safety Auditor under DFS (Amendment) Rules- 2025".

For details of eligibility please refer schedule VII of Delhi Fire Service (Amended) Rules 2025 (https://dfs.delhi.gov.in/sites/default/files/Dfs/dfs_amendment_rules_2025.pdf).

Sh. Mukesh Verma, Divisional Officer (Mobile No. 9810445332) is the Nodal Officer for any query/ clarification.

(Sachin Rana)
IAS
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0161/26-27
Principal Director



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Tender No.3023277/TD2/2026

Date: 04.08.2026

Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu (SDAT) invites tender (QCBS) for appointment of an Agency to supply and deploy 35 qualified Chefs at 44 SDAT Residential Sports Facilities across six Regions of Tamil Nadu

Date of Prebid Meeting	17.08.2026 at 3:00 PM
Last Date of submission of Tender	27.08.2026 up to 3:00 PM
Date of Tender opening	28.08.2026 at 3:00 PM

For complete details and tender documents, visit <http://tntenders.gov.in>

DIP/R/ 2441 /Tender/2026

Member Secretary



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ई-निविदा सूचना

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The detailed advertisement, eligibility criteria, application procedure and prescribed application format are available on www.phfiiphs.ac.in.

Last Date for Submission of Applications: 30 August 2026

Sd/- ROHIT TIWARI, Registrar

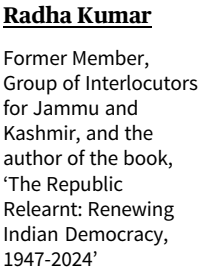


In Datia, the Congress secured an important victory as its candidate, Ghanshyam Singh, defeated BJP candidate Ashutosh Tiwari by just over 6,000 votes. Unlike Bankipur, Datia witnessed a robust voter turnout of 71.44%, indicating strong local engagement with the contest and suggesting that the Congress retains pockets of resilience in Madhya Pradesh despite the BJP's dominance. The victory does not alter the balance of power in the Assembly, but gives the Congress evidence that local anti-incumbency and candidate-specific factors can still work in its favour. For the BJP, the defeat serves as a reminder that its Statewide strength does not automatically translate into victory in every constituency. The third contest, in Manjalpur produced a different outcome. The BJP retained the constituency, with Satish Govindbhai Patel defeating his rival by over 30,000 votes. Manjalpur demonstrates the BJP's ability to hold its core support base. At the same time, the outcomes in Bankipur and Datia suggest some volatility among the BJP's core social base of Hindu voters, particularly the upper castes. There is also a larger acceptance among the electorate for fresh political experiments, and that is a trend that connects what happened in the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections with Bankipur. If this trend holds, the challenge will be not only for the BJP but also for other legacy parties, including and particularly the Congress.

India needs to upgrade infrastructure, train coaches

A novel concept of upgrading the knowledge of local coaches by helping them overcome the language barrier posed by English, the formation of a National Coach Accreditation Board to standardise coaching and better utilisation of physical education teachers are expected to impart correct training at the basic level. In sync with the National Education Policy, the Khelo India Feeder Schools and Khelo India Utkrisha Vidyalaya initiatives are designed to integrate education and sports. The existing Khelo India Athletes programme, with 2,904 athletes, and the new Emerging Khelo India Athletes initiative aim to expand the talent pool to around 28,000. Talent identification, digitisation of the sports ecosystem to maintain data on every athlete, and a bottom-to-top communication channel are its key components. The overall outlay, including assistance to National Sports Federations, stands at a staggering ₹36,441 crore for 2026-31. However, the biggest challenge will be effective and transparent implementation of the scheme. Enabling talent to graduate to the highest level, already backed by the Target Olympic Podium Scheme, with an eye on the 2036 Olympics and beyond will be crucial. The 2030 Commonwealth Games in Ahmedabad will be an immediate test. The other major hurdle for India's attempt to emerge as a sporting power is its dubious distinction as a doping hub. Strict anti-doping measures, promotion of a sports culture by maximising the scope of the Fit India Movement, and a focus on grass-roots development must go hand-in-hand to achieve the desired results.

At the time, few recognised how momentous



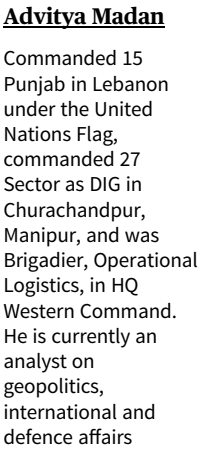
Seven years on,
J&K still awaits
restored
Statehood and
accountable
governance

Lieutenant-Governor holds power

The Constitution limited the imposition of emergency conditions to six months. Yet, in J&K, emergency conditions have not been lifted for seven years. Though the J&K High Court has repeatedly and increasingly lamented the misuse of draconian laws by the J&K police, its strictures do not appear to have led to reform. J&K held elections two years ago, but the elected

Is it not time for J&K to experience some positive firsts instead of suffering only ugly ones? After all, it was the first State to overcome communal gerrymandering when the 2024 elections yielded a majority for the pluralist National Conference-Congress alliance. It is only fitting that it also be the first State to regain the Statehood that has been withheld for so long.

This rebalancing is already evident. Following Russia's invasion of Ukraine in 2022, U.S. troop strength in Europe rose to around 1,00,000 personnel. Since then, Washington has gradually reversed that surge. During 2025-26, it withdrew around 5,000 troops from Germany, cancelled the planned deployment of 4,000 troops to Poland, and reduced Brigade Combat Teams in Europe from four to three, bringing the U.S. military presence in Europe down to approximately 75,000-80,000 troops – close to pre-Ukraine war levels. The 36th NATO Summit in Ankara in July 2026 reinforced this transition. While reaffirming the Alliance's commitment to Article 5, members pledged €70 billion in military assistance for Ukraine in 2026, committed to sustaining comparable support in 2027, endorsed European-led development of long-range



NATO's European shift offers India new strategic and defence opportunities

The scale of Europe's response was evident at the 2025 Hague Summit, where NATO members committed to increasing core defence spending to at least 3.5 % of GDP by 2035, with progress to be reviewed in 2029. Germany has doubled defence expenditure since 2023 and aims to reach the same target by 2029 while rebuilding military capability to deter Russia. Moscow, meanwhile, has reorganised its western military

New Delhi should therefore view these changes through the prism of strategic opportunity rather than alliance politics. Closer cooperation with both the U.S. and Europe can complement, not compromise, India's long-standing commitment to strategic autonomy. If navigated prudently, NATO's new strategic model can expand India's defence industrial partnerships, accelerate technological modernisation and strengthen its position as a leading power in an increasingly multipolar world.

before his foray into electoral politics. History shows that by-elections have rarely been game changers. The Opposition should remain pragmatic and not read too much into these results.

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Delimitation may be less attractive for BJP now

Jantar Mantar and Bankipur, taken together, may make the prospect of an early delimitation exercise far less attractive for the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) than it once appeared. For much of the last decade, the BJP had reasons to believe that it had assembled a durable social majority, with Hindus acting as a voting bloc across large parts of north and west India. If groups displayed stable voting preferences over long periods, then redrawing constituency boundaries could amplify existing advantages.

Engineering constituency boundaries to advance a particular political outcome, commonly called gerrymandering, rests precisely on this premise: that electoral loyalties of social groups are predictable. It is reasonable to assume, for instance, that Muslims are less likely to vote for the BJP, just as African Americans have historically been less likely to vote Republican than Democratic in the U.S. Gerrymandering works by stacking and cracking electorates according to such group identities and their assumed preferences.

The BJP has had reason to assume that it built a threshold Hindu voting bloc that could provide it with a permanent majority, albeit with regional variations. The party's continuing electoral triumphs in Gujarat is an example. One reason for its enthusiasm for an early delimitation exercise, which under the existing constitutional scheme can take place only after the data from the Census is published, has been to explore the possibility of redrawing Lok Sabha and Assembly constituencies to maximise its demographic advantage. This is not merely an assumption or an allegation. Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma has publicly stated that the delimitation of Assembly constituencies in the State was intended to reduce the number of seats in which Muslims could influence the outcome. The subsequent electoral outcome



Varghese K. George

A young Brahmin, a young Dalit and a young OBC voter may occupy very different positions in the social hierarchy, yet they can share common anxieties about jobs, mobility, and examinations

suggests that the exercise worked in the party's favour. Yet politics has a habit of unsettling certainties.

An unforeseen twist Bankipur's demographic composition is almost a dream scenario for the BJP. Out of roughly 3.8 lakh voters, around 1.6 lakh are upper-caste Hindus, the party's strongest social base. Muslims number about 40,000 and Yadavs roughly the same. In effect, the constituency has just enough communities considered adversarial to the BJP, namely the Muslims and Yadavs, to generate counter-polarisation on religious and caste lines, while still allowing the party to build a larger coalition of upper castes, Other Backward Classes (OBCs) and Dalits.

For years, Bankipur represented an ideal laboratory for the BJP's twin strategy of caste and religious consolidation. Yet the party's defeat at the hands of Jan Suraj founder Prashant Kishore suggests that these assumptions may no longer hold automatically. Mr. Kishore's victory appears to have rested on a social coalition that cut across caste and religious boundaries.

Something similar happened in Datia, though in a very different setting. Datia's electorate of about 2.2 lakh is overwhelmingly Hindu. It has around 35,000 Brahmins, more than 30,000 Scheduled Caste voters, over 80,000 OBC voters spread across several communities, and another 25,000 to 30,000 Thakur and Vaishya voters. Muslims account for only a small proportion of the electorate. While the relatively new Jan Suraj could sweep aside the BJP in Bankipur, the Congress could only secure a narrow victory in Datia. The dynamism within the Hindu electorate makes any permanent assumptions about its political preferences risky for the BJP.

Emergence of a new category What links Jantar Mantar and Bankipur is the emergence of a political variable that neither the

BJP nor its opponents had adequately anticipated: Gen Z as a distinct political community. The protests and mobilisations around issues of recruitment, examinations, unemployment and representation have revealed a generation that does not fit neatly into traditional electoral boxes. It is not that Gen Z voters are caste-agnostic. In fact, they appear to be deeply caste-conscious, expressed in sharply different ways, ranging from anti-reservation arguments to assertive Ambedkarite politics. Yet these divergent strands often converge in their scepticism towards the BJP and, in many cases, towards established political parties in general.

This horizontal social category complicates the older vertical structures of caste and religious mobilisation. A young Brahmin, a young Dalit and a young OBC voter may occupy very different positions in the social hierarchy, yet they can share common anxieties about jobs, mobility, and examinations. Their political choices are therefore not always determined by inherited community loyalties.

The disintegration of the BJP's seemingly perfect constituency in Bankipur and the emergence of Gen Z politics suggest that politics in the Hindi heartland is not a prisoner of constituency boundaries. Electoral behaviour is increasingly shaped by cross-cutting identities that intersect with caste and religion but do not fully submit to them.

This challenges the logic of an early delimitation exercise for the BJP. Constituency engineering can magnify an advantage only when the social coalitions remain stable. If the party's traditional bloc is showing signs of strain, redrawing boundaries can only do so much. The more urgent task for the BJP may be to mend its own camp and restore its social base than redrawing the boundaries of constituencies.

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Political discourse still fails women leaders

In Maharashtra, Congress is facing backlash for its remarks against the Deputy CM

STATE OF PLAY

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit

Ma-harashtra politics came to a boil after the ruling Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) protested against the Opposition, mainly the Congress, for calling its national president Sunetra Pawar "Goongi Gudiya" or a "dumb doll". Ms. Pawar is also the Deputy Chief Minister of Maharashtra.

The irony isn't lost here. The Congress is the same party which had once raised its voice against similar criticism about its leader and former Prime Minister Indira Gandhi.

And yet, the party refused to apologise or withdraw its comment from its official X account. Instead, the party threw an open challenge at Ms. Pawar, asking her to prove that she was not a "dumb doll". It doled out a list of demands, which, if fulfilled, will prove that she is an avatar of 'Durga', the party said. Both the constructs are equally problematic, and reek of misogyny and patronising behaviour.

The incident

What was noteworthy was the presence of patronising behaviour from both the sides. While the Congress faced immediate backlash for its comments, the incident due to which this comment was made, showed Ms. Pawar's own party leader treating her in a patronising manner.

The incident in question was a press conference conducted by Sunetra Pawar in Beed in Marathwada. While answering questions about several issues, she kept referring to her late husband and former Deputy Chief Minister Ajit Pawar, expressing how she was only trying to fulfil his



dream and vision. She was flanked by NCP leader Dhannanjay Munde, who not only stopped a journalist from asking a difficult question, but also ushered Ms. Pawar out of the press event. Mr. Munde kept intervening when questions were being addressed to Ms. Pawar.

It was this video that the Congress tagged, asking Ms. Pawar when she will stop being a "Goongi Gudiya". NCP leader Udaykumar Aher said the comment was an insult to the entire Pawar family; he appealed to Ms. Pawar's uncle-in-law Sharad Pawar, who heads the NCP-SP and sits in alliance with the Congress, to extract an apology from the party, or leave the INDIA bloc in protest.

Senior Congress leaders said the comment was 'silly' and should have been avoided. "Congress has a history and should have taken the responsibility of setting the discourse at a higher pedestal. While there is hardly any awareness about gender issues in our political narrative, it is Congress party's responsibility to maintain dignity in dialogue," senior Congress leader Prithviraj Chavan said.

But a few leaders said that it also reflected the overall deterioration of political discourse in the State. They claimed that outrage over derogatory comments had become selective and that leaders from the ruling dispensation had used worse words while hitting out

at the Opposition. Officially, the Congress has, as of yet, refused to issue an apology or withdraw its comment.

Abysmal track record This isn't the first time misogynistic comments have been made in Maharashtra's politics. Neither does the issue restrict itself to any particular political party. A few years ago, Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) minister Chandrakant Patil had asked NCP MP Supriya Sule to "go home and cook," when she had questioned the government about OBC reservations. Ahead of the 2024 Assembly elections, Shiv Sena-UBT (Uddhav Balasahab Thackeray) leader Arvind Sawant had referred to Shiv Sena leader Shaina NC as "imported maal".

A 2020 study by Amnesty International India, 'Troll Patrol India,' had shown how female politicians face more abusive language. The report had analysed over 1,14,000 tweets sent to 95 female politicians and found that one in seven posts (or 13%) were 'problematic' or 'abusive'.

"This amounted to an average of 113 abusive tweets per day for each woman politician," it had reported.

The study said that Indian female leaders faced substantially higher levels of online harassment than their counterparts in the U.K. or the U.S.

Now, the NCP has asked Sonia Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra if they endorsed this culture in their party, questioning if the Congress will condemn these sexist remarks. In a society where political discourse across party lines rarely shows gender sensitivity, the behaviour of a national party calls for condemnation.

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Ahead of TVK's maiden budget, a primer on T.N.'s finances

Robust growth notwithstanding the State's debt servicing has forced increased borrowing for welfare expenditure

DATA POINT

Compiled by Pon Vasanth B.A.

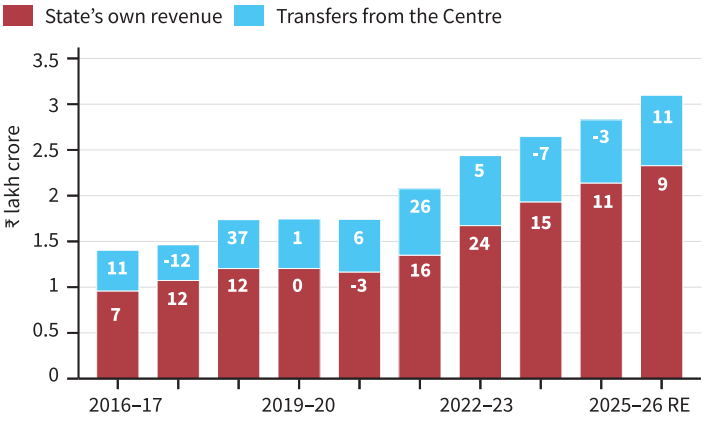
STRONGER GROWTH

TABLE 1: TN saw strong growth in GSDP, compared with India's largest economies, post pandemic. TN closed its gap with MH's GSDP and widened the same with the others. TN's GSDP was 65% of MH's in 2022-23 and 69% in 2025-26

State	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26
MH*	31.4 (11.2)	36.7 (11.0)	41.2 (8.9)	46.2 (7.3)	51.0 (7.9)
TN*	20.7 (7.9)	23.7 (6.2)	26.9 (9.3)	31.2 (11.2)	35.3 (10.8)
KA*	19.9 (10.2)	23.3 (10.8)	25.9 (8.2)	29.1 (7.3)	32.8 (8.1)
U.P.*	20.3 (11.2)	23.0 (7.4)	26.7 (10.7)	30.2 (10.8)	31*
GUJ*	19.2 (10.0)	21.9 (7.9)	24.5 (9.2)	27.0 (7.4)	29.8 (8.6)

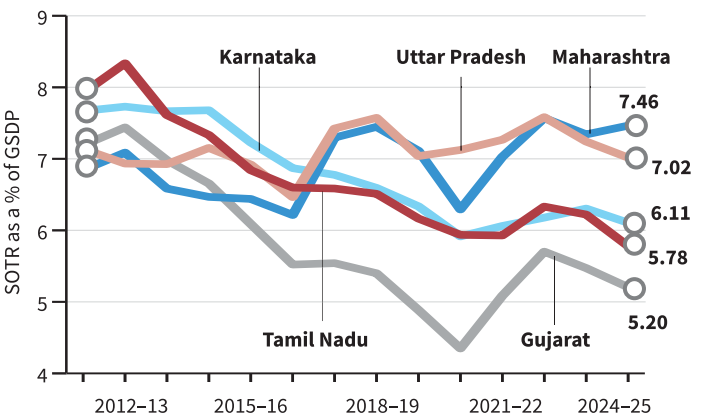
STATE'S REVENUE GREW, CENTRAL GRANTS SHRANK

CHART 1: TN's own revenue grew at a reasonable rate, but central transfers (share in central taxes and grants-in-aid) shrunk, mainly due to the discontinuation of GST compensation cess in 2022. Values inside bars show growth rates (%)



REVENUE GREW, BUT NOT IN PROPORTION TO ECONOMY

CHART 2: Despite reasonable growth, the State's Own Tax Revenue (SOTR)'s growth as a share of its economy paled in comparison with the other larger economies. TN led in 2011-12, but declined to the fourth spot in 2024-25



DEBT GREW FASTER THAN REVENUE

CHART 3: TN's outstanding liabilities grew at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 16.2% from ₹1.92 lakh crore in 2014-15 to ₹8.57 lakh crore in 2024-25, which is nearly twice the CAGR of 8.7% at which its SOTR grew in the same period

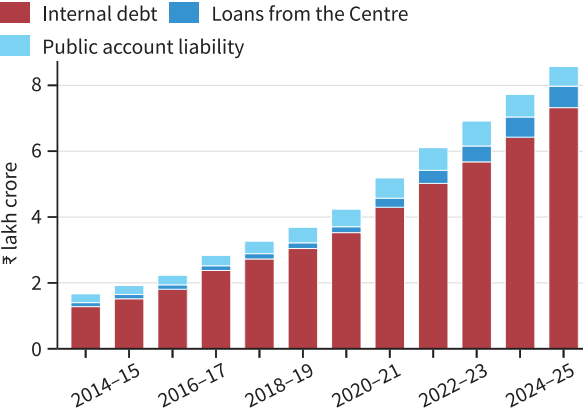


CHART 4: TN's Debt-to-GSDP ratio moved in the opposite direction, compared with its SOTR-to-GSDP ratio (Chart 2). Its Debt-to-GSDP ratio was the second lowest in 2014-15 and the highest 2024-25

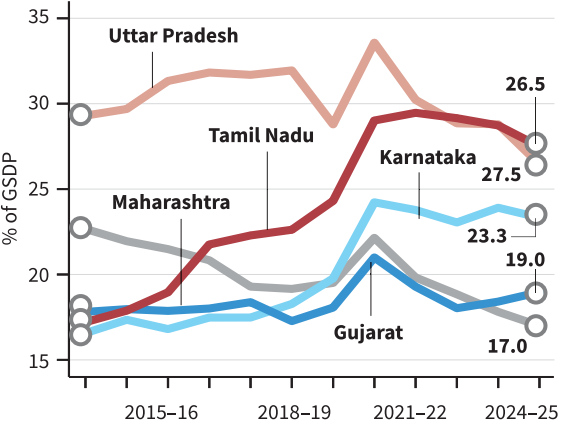
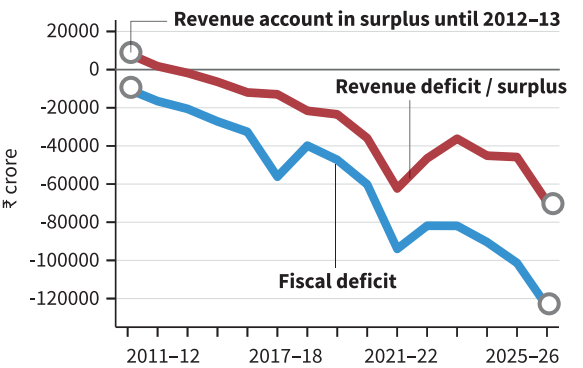


CHART 5: TN's revenue deficit, which was 23.6% of its fiscal deficit in 2014-15, is 55.8% in 2025-26. Revenue deficit is expected to hit record high in the full budget to be presented on August 5, 2026



THE DEBT-SERVICING TRAP

CHART 6: TN spends more on interest payments than on capital outlay since 2017-18. The interest payments are also higher than subsidies for various welfare measures

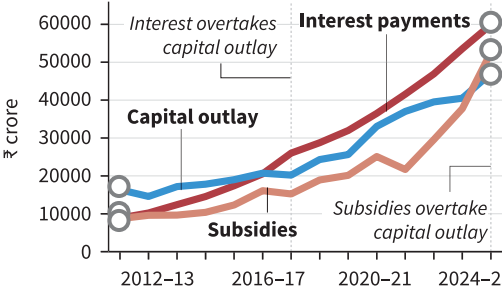
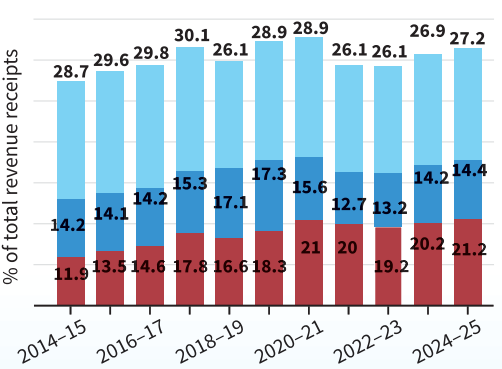


CHART 7: TN's pensions and salaries as a share of total revenue receipts have remained fairly at the same level, but share of interest payments has nearly doubled



Sources: TN Budgets, Comptroller and Auditor General of India's State Finances reports, Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, 2025-26 values are Revised Estimates or provisional figures. Value for real growth rate not available for U.P. for 2025-26 in MoSPI reports. *GSDP - Gross State Domestic Product, MH - Maharashtra, TN - Tamil Nadu, KA - Karnataka, U.P. - Uttar Pradesh, GUJ - Gujarat



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 5, 1976

Gold sales suggested to mop up savings

New Delhi, August 4: The Union Government is understood to be examining a suggestion that it should utilise the present foreign exchange reserves for the purchase of gold in the international market and sell it in the rural areas as part of a concerted drive to mop up the savings from these areas.

This novel suggestion is among a few others put forward by several economists for stepping up the mobilisation of savings to augment the resources for the Fifth Plan.

It has also been suggested that there may be some difficulties for the Government itself to buy gold abroad, but the State Trading Corporation could be asked to buy the gold from the Trust Fund of the International Monetary Fund. It has further been suggested that part of the gold reserves available with the Reserve Bank of India could also be used for internal sales in the rural areas.

The quarters from which the suggestion had been made are understood to have pointed out that the rural community, consisting predominantly of farmers, has yet to take to any sophisticated saving habit, whether in company shares or bank deposits, and are still very much drawn to gold. If gold is officially offered for sale, there is bound to be a big response these quarters expect.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 5, 1926

Rise of Franc

London, August 4: The French franc in London opened this morning at 178.50.

Paris, August 4: Newspapers are delighted at the rise of the franc, which they attribute to the confidence inspired by the Government of National Union and the prestige of M. Poincare.

"Echo de Paris" remarks that it is no longer a question of foreign credits and believes that the price of bread will shortly be reduced.

The Manchester Guardian's Paris correspondent says that the recovery of the franc is due to the increase of Banque De France's rate of discount, which suddenly restricted credit and compelled traders and manufacturers to cease the practice of assuring working capital against loss by retaining pounds or dollars or by holding increasing stocks of goods.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Worth of PM Mudra Yojana loans approved by Rajasthan

2.18 in ₹ lakh crore. Rajasthan has sanctioned loans worth over ₹ 2.18 lakh crore to more than 2.55 crore beneficiaries under the Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY), with women accounting for around 60 per cent of beneficiaries, an official statement says. Of these, more than 1.54 crore women have availed loans worth over ₹67,982 crore. PTI

Number of migrants rescued while crossing the English Channel

157 French and British vessels rescued 157 migrants after their boat caught fire while attempting to cross the English Channel on Tuesday, authorities in both countries said. The boat caught fire near the boundary between French and British waters, forcing its occupants to jump overboard. No casualties were reported, according to French authorities. AFP

Amount approved by Centre for Meghalaya under JJM 2.0

336 In ₹ crore. The Centre has approved ₹ 336.62 crore for Meghalaya under the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0 for the financial year 2026-27, Public Health Engineering (PHE) Minister Marcuise Marak said. The sanctioned amount will enable the clearance of at least one-third of the pending bills of contractors executing drinking water projects. PTI

Fugitives repatriated to India from 36 countries since 2019

274 India has repatriated 274 fugitives from 36 countries since 2019, averaging around 40 a year, compared with about four annually during 2004-13, the government said on Tuesday. Assets worth ₹ 17,874 crore belonging to fugitives have also been attached under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act during the period. PTI

Number of heatstroke deaths reported across India since March 1

20 India has reported 4,853 heatstroke cases across the country since March 1 this year, with 20 people dying from heatstroke, according to government data tabled in the Lok Sabha on Tuesday. Maharashtra recorded the highest number of deaths at 11, followed by Andhra Pradesh with four, Telangana and Odisha with two each. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Out of work and outraged

While the immediate trigger for the students' protest at Jantar Mantar was the repeated paper leaks, disillusionment among the youth runs much deeper. India has a significant youth population; however, unemployment remains high. Additionally, access to quality education has become limited due to a number of factors

ECONOMIC NOTES

Rohit Azad
Indranil Chowdhury

It won't be an exaggeration to say that the Jantar Mantar protest led by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) is by far the most formidable challenge this government has faced in its 12 years of rule. While it was the issue of repeated paper leaks which pushed the people over the brink, the disillusionment runs far deeper among young Indians. And there is a material basis for this disillusionment. Unfortunately, neither the defiant resignation letter of the Minister nor the rousing welcome he got in the Parliament after the resignation gives the impression that the government has heard the voice of its own youth with any humility. The question, then, is: why did the agitation catch the imagination of the youth?

A lost demographic advantage
Let us start with what is called a demographic dividend. India currently has the youngest population in the world. **Chart 1** shows a rising share of people in the working age bracket (15-64 years) out of the total population – a potential demographic dividend. We are calling it potential because its mere existence does not guarantee its realisation. If the unemployment rates, especially among those entering the labour market, remain high, we are essentially frittering the youth dividend away. **Chart 2**, which compares the unemployment rate among the youth (15-29 years) in contrast to the overall workers, shows that India is indeed turning its face away from its youth. Youth unemployment is three times higher than the overall rate. Among women, it is almost four times higher. Urban women are the worst affected. Nearly one in five women looking for work is unable to find a job. It is therefore no surprise that a significantly large section of those protesting were women students. And the frustration runs deep because even education is not enough to find a job in the Indian markets. **Chart 3** shows that unemployment rises with education. The more educated you are, the less likely you are to land yourself a job. So, lack of jobs for the youth is not a supply but a demand side problem. Youth in India are unemployed not because they are not educated but because the economy is not generating enough jobs for them.

The crisis in education
It is not just a lack of jobs; access to quality education is also becoming increasingly limited. This is due to both quantitative and qualitative reasons. On the quantitative side, it is perhaps for the first time in India's history that spending on education as a percentage of GDP has declined consistently for over a decade. While the government's own National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 recommended a significant increase in spending on education, the reality is the opposite. Spending on education as a share of the total budget has been declining consistently under the current government (**Chart 4**). This is a significant point that cannot be stressed enough. Strictly speaking, spending as a proportion of GDP could decline purely because other components (investments, exports, consumption) of GDP can potentially grow faster. In contrast, the share of its own budget that a government allocates to education is entirely at its discretion and reflects the importance it



Protesters demonstrate against the NTA and the alleged irregularities in the NEET-UG and NET exams in New Delhi, on July 4, 2026. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

National, centralised admission tests such as the CUET result in considerable shifting of admissions, not just across institutions but across the country

attaches to the sector. **Chart 4** clearly shows that education has been slipping from the radar of this government over its tenure so far. This was yet another case of a failed promise, to which the students responded with their feet on Jantar Mantar (and elsewhere in the country). The low priority accorded to education by this government becomes even clearer when one looks at what it did in the last Budget. They spent way below what they promised in their budget with a shortfall amounting to ₹6,701 crores (**Chart 5**).

Starving education of funds creates a serious supply bottleneck as far as access to education is concerned. While the number of applicants rises with the growing youth dividend, the number of seats does not. The odds of securing a seat even in an average institution, let alone a premier one, keeps declining every year. Added to this are the changing of goalposts by the government. One year, CBSE results are used for college admissions; the next, they are not. One year there is one entrance examination; the next, another.

Let us take the example of the Common University Entrance Test (CUET). If you want to join a college for an undergraduate (UG) degree, what you scored in your CBSE/ICSE/State board examinations no longer matters as much; what matters is how you perform in the Computer-Based

Test (CBT) with multiple-choice questions (MCQs) under CUET (UG). If you want to do post-graduation (PG), what you did in your UG college for three or four years comes to naught, instead what matters again is what you did in the MCQ of CBT under CUET(PG). As a result, teaching and learning in schools and colleges have been affected. Students are being forced to prepare only for their CUET exams instead of focussing on a holistic teaching and learning process. It is therefore no surprise that, instead of quality educational institutions, coaching centres that help students crack these MCQs are mushrooming across the country.

As if this were not enough, the logistical nightmare that CUET brings to the table at the time of admissions is mind boggling. The National Testing Agency (NTA) conducts the CUET, and there have been glitches since its inception. Academic sessions do not begin on time in many of the institutions that depend on these examinations. National, centralised admission tests also result in considerable shifting of admissions, not just across institutions but across the country. As a result, you have students joining the programme almost half way through the first semester. CUET has disrupted the admissions process in higher education. One could understand if these were teething troubles but this is the fifth year of CUET, and there is still no respite from this chaos.

Another bizarre example was introducing the scanning of CBSE answer scripts for evaluation in the name of objectivity. Given the massive scale of the CBSE examinations in the country, expecting such a policy to work smoothly was unrealistic from the outset.

Interestingly, there was nothing fundamentally wrong with the previous systems of either entrance examinations or CBSE evaluations. The government seems to have followed the maxim, "fix what isn't broken."

All this shows that not only is there an uncertainty of passing an exam, there is an uncertainty surrounding the exam itself. If the readers put themselves in the shoes of a student today, they would know what these students must be going through. One may argue that we are being a tad unfair to this government. After all, it has established new IITs and AIIMS. While this is true, merely increasing the number of institutions, with an overall fund squeeze, may not mean much. Buildings do not make institutions.

As for the quality of education, it is not infrastructure alone that matters, the quality of teaching does too. If the reports in the media were to be believed (and there is incontrovertible evidence to do so), there has been excessive political interference in the appointment of teachers at public universities. As a result, the quality of teaching has been sacrificed at the altar of politics under this regime. None of this is, or can be, hidden from students.

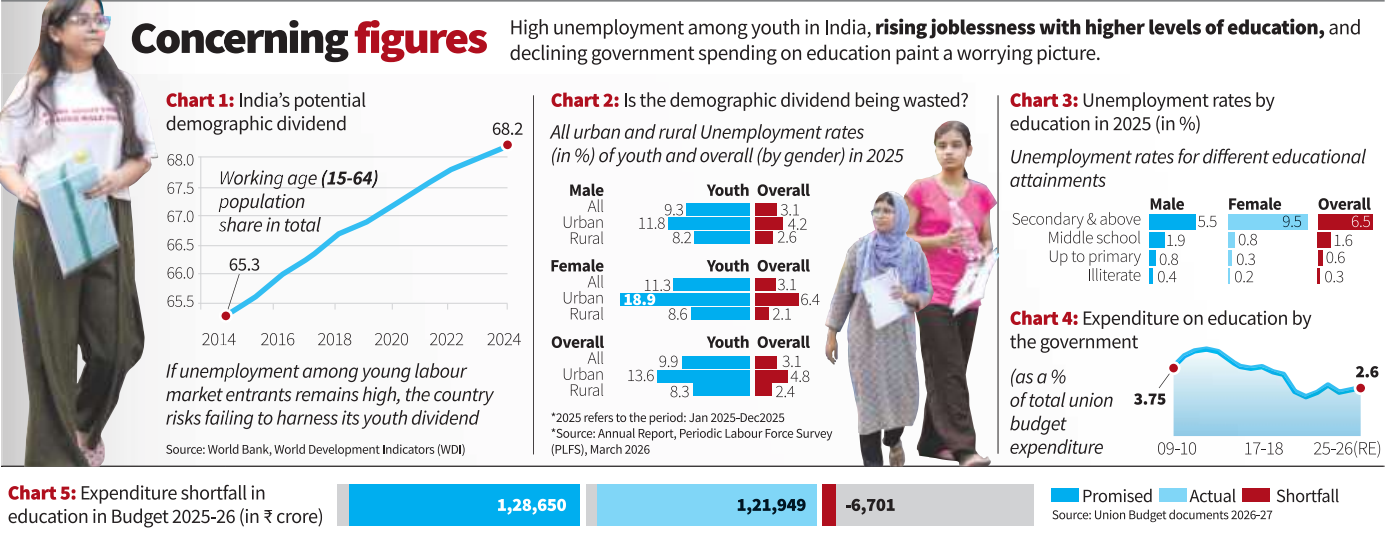
The Chief Justice of India gave an outlet to this simmering anger by calling those questioning the system 'cockroaches'. Much like the cockroaches that possess incredible biological resilience, allowing them to survive for weeks without a head, the youth of this country braved the batons, tear gas, pellet guns and whatever the government threw at them. *(The authors are a part of DevMac (Development Macroeconomics) network, which seeks pluralism in Economics.)*

THE GIST

India currently has a large youth population. If unemployment rates, especially among those entering the labour market, remain high, the country risks frittering away its demographic dividend.

While the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 recommended a significant increase in spending on education, government expenditure on education as a share of the total budget has been declining consistently. The lack of funding creates a serious supply bottleneck for educational opportunities.

The logistical uncertainties associated with CUET in undergraduate admissions, along with reported excessive political interference in the appointment of teachers at public universities, have also adversely affected the education sector.



CACHE

What can be done to curb ‘paper leaks’ and ensure institutional accountability?

Despite the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, the fundamental need to fix accountability for detecting examination breaches, preventing them and preserving the integrity of public examinations remains

Rajeev Kumar

NEET is one of India’s highest-stakes examinations, where intense competition, immense social prestige, and the multi-crore value of a medical seat generate enormous academic, financial, and psychological pressure. Similar pressures surround other national admission, scholarship and recruitment examinations. In such an environment, paper leaks and other irregularities have repeatedly surfaced.

The controversies surrounding NEET-2024, UGC-NET 2024, and NEET-2026 triggered unprecedented national concern. UGC-NET 2024 was canceled and held again, while NEET 2026 was also re-conducted. All three were conducted by the National Testing Agency (NTA), which attributed these decisions to specific external or intelligence inputs.

The CBI investigated the NEET-2024 and UGC-NET 2024 cases. Although the investigations initially led to arrests and extensive nationwide media coverage, the CBI has since submitted closure reports in both cases, reportedly finding no prosecutable evidence of a conventional paper leak under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), 2023, or the Public Examinations Act (PEA), 2024. The NEET-2026 investigation remains in progress, with a chargesheet already filed.

These developments raise a more fundamental question: if repeated examination crises ultimately yield no prosecutable evidence of a conventional paper leak, what exactly constitutes a “paper leak”? Where do such compromises originate, and who is responsible for detecting, preventing, and being held accountable for them?

Defining a ‘paper leak’

Traditionally, a “paper leak” refers to the unauthorised disclosure of a printed question paper before the examination, typically during printing, packaging, storage, or transportation. Investigation protocols, therefore, focus on tracing printed papers and recovering physical evidence. The recent Maharashtra Teachers Eligibility Test (TET) case is a classic example in which coded printed question papers were allegedly leaked from a compromised printing press.

High-stakes examinations, however, present a far more complex picture. Long before printing, questions pass through question-setting, moderation, translation, digitisation, and final compilation, where a limited number of individuals have privileged access. Compromises at any of these stages may never result in a leaked printed paper. Yet, it can selectively disclose questions or other confidential material, providing an unfair advantage to a few candidates before spreading through organised networks.

The NEET and UGC-NET controversies illustrate this distinction. Although investigations reportedly found no evidence of leaked printed papers in the 2024 cases, the examinations nevertheless led to arrests, cancellations, re-examinations, and a crisis of public confidence. Similarly, the circulation of highly targeted “guided papers” before NEET-2026 raised questions about whether confidential information had



Students entering an examination centre in Udupi during the NEET exam on June 21, 2026. FILE PHOTO

flowed through insider or informal networks despite the absence of any recovered printed paper.

Examination compromise may therefore involve far more than a printed paper: selected questions, question banks, recurring themes, high-probability question pools, examiner identities, confidential instructions, digital data, or administrative information may all be unlawfully disclosed through insider access, cyber intrusions, or coaching networks.

Restricting the definition of a “paper leak” to a leaked printed question paper overlooks these significant vulnerabilities. In this context, extraordinary measures such as transporting the re-NEET 2026 question papers by aircraft may secure the final logistical stage but do little to address vulnerabilities at the source. The real issue is whether confidential examination information was disclosed in any form that compromised the fairness, integrity, or credibility of the examination.

Other examination breaches

The integrity of an examination may be undermined equally by failures before, during, or after the examination, even when no printed paper is ever recovered.

NEET-2024 illustrates this broader spectrum. Reported irregularities included the distribution of an incorrect question paper, followed by its replacement; delayed collection or replacement of OMR sheets; exceptional grace marks; tie-breaking disputes; clustering of near-perfect scores; and unusually high scores from certain centres and coaching hubs. Collectively, these exposed weaknesses in examination management and institutional oversight.

Other breaches include cybersecurity failures, manipulation of candidate or examination data, disclosure of confidential information, compromised examination centres, impersonation, organised unfair means, and insider access or coaching-network access to privileged information.

Safeguarding public examinations,

therefore, requires securing the entire examination lifecycle – from question development to result processing.

Failures in the transport of printed question papers alone cannot explain many examination breaches. Critical processes—including question selection, paper allocation, examination-centre management, OMR handling, grace marks, result processing, cybersecurity, and access to confidential data—are controlled by the examination authority and its associated agencies. Irregularities at these stages naturally raise questions about institutional controls and insider vulnerabilities.

The NEET-2024 controversy illustrates this broader picture. Distribution of an incorrect question paper, delayed OMR handling, exceptional grace marks, unusually high scores from certain centres, and the circulation of highly targeted “guided papers” all point to vulnerabilities that extend beyond conventional paper leaks. Such patterns warrant scrutiny of repeated expert engagement, conflicts of interest, links to coaching ecosystems, and other insider risks. This does not imply that every irregularity results from insider misconduct. However, securing examinations requires protecting confidential information, institutional processes, and printed question papers alike.

Primary accountability

Preventing examination breaches cannot be left to the CBI, police, or courts, which act only after a crisis. Primary responsibility lies with the examination authority, supported by the Ministry of Education, intelligence, and cybersecurity agencies, and independent oversight.

Accountability should extend across the entire examination lifecycle – from the selection of question setters and translators to examination centres, digital systems, evaluation, and result processing. It requires rigorous antecedent verification, conflict-of-interest scrutiny, periodic

rotation of experts, cybersecurity audits, intelligence-based monitoring, and clear audit trails.

Official narrative and unanswered questions

The official response to the NEET-2024, UGC-NET 2024, and NEET-2026 controversies has largely rested on the absence of conclusive evidence of a conventional paper leak. Before the Supreme Court, the NTA attributed the cancellation and re-conduct of NEET-2026 to specific intelligence inputs, while the High-Powered Steering Committee emphasised compliance with its recommendations and SOPs. The CBI’s investigations into NEET-2024 and UGC-NET 2024 resulted in closure reports, reportedly finding no prosecutable evidence of a paper leak and no basis to prosecute NTA officials. The NEET-2026 investigation, however, remains ongoing.

These official positions contrast sharply with the ground reality. Cancelled or re-conducted examinations, arrests, allegations of widely circulated “guided papers”, cyber-security incidents, operational lapses, and disruptions affecting millions of candidates. In NEET-2026, official action reportedly followed a whistleblower’s FIR rather than detection through the examination’s own security or intelligence systems.

This raises an obvious question: if no credible abnormality was detected, what justified cancelling NEET-2026? Conversely, if credible intelligence existed, why did institutional safeguards fail to detect or prevent the compromise beforehand?

Until these questions are answered transparently, stronger logistics or harsher penal laws alone are unlikely to restore public confidence. The priority must shift from post-crisis response to institutional prevention.

The way forward

As its first task, the newly constituted committee headed by former UIDAI chairman Nandan Nilekani should prepare a comprehensive White Paper documenting the full spectrum of breaches in NEET-2024, UGC-NET 2024, and NEET-2026—covering leakages, operational failures, cybersecurity incidents, centre-level irregularities, investigations, judicial outcomes, and lessons learned.

The White Paper should underpin a Public Examination Integrity Framework (PEIF) for all major examination bodies. The Framework should prescribe standardised end-to-end SOPs covering the entire examination lifecycle, with an emphasis on conflict-of-interest management, expert selection, cybersecurity, examination administration, audit, and institutional accountability.

Ultimately, public confidence will be restored not by tougher laws or more post-facto investigations, but by an examination system that detects risks early, prevents breaches before they occur, and ensures institutional accountability. (Rajeev Kumar is a former Computer Science Professor at IIT Kharagpur, IIT Kanpur, BITS Pilani, and JNU, and a former scientist at DRDO and DST.)



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

“Weren’t you supposed to come over and have dinner with me yesterday?”

“That’s right. But there was a problem.”

“...what was the problem?”

“My cousin rang me up around 6:00 and asked me to come over. You see his landlord’s son is returning from the U.S. So the landlord wants my cousin to vacate the flat by the end of the month. My cousin and I were out all evening trying to find a suitable accommodation.”

“Did you find one?”

“No. It’s so hard to find an accommodation these days.”

“You cannot say ‘an accommodation’.

In British English the word ‘accommodation’ is an uncountable noun. So you shouldn’t use ‘an’ before it.”

“Really? I didn’t know that! How about this sentence? There is a shortage of cheap accommodation in our city.”

“Sounds pretty good. ”

“The university refused to provide the teachers free accommodation.”

“...by the way, this cousin of yours.

What does he do?”

“He’s an academician.”

“He’s an academician? Which academy does he belong to?”

“What are you talking about?”

“Well you said that he was an academician.”

“...he doesn’t belong to any academy.

What I meant to say was that he is a teacher. He teaches at the university.”

“A teacher, eh? In that case, the word you are looking for is ‘academic’.”

“What is the difference between an ‘academic’ and ‘academician’?”

“Well, strictly speaking, an ‘academic’ is a person who teaches or does research at the university.”

“I see. How about this example? When I grow up I certainly don’t want to be an academic.”

“The example is OK. But the word ‘academic’ has the stress on the third syllable ‘de’.”

“But a lot of people I know...”

“...tend to put the stress on the second syllable. But the stress is on the third. The ‘a’ in the first syllable is like the ‘a’ in ‘cat’ and ‘sat’’. while the ‘a’ in the second syllable is pronounced like the ‘a’ in ‘China’. And ...”

“...I think I can guess the rest. The ‘e’ probably sounds like the ‘e’ in ‘set’ and ‘get’. The final ‘i’ must be like the ‘i’ in ‘sit’.”

“Exactly! Radhakrishnan was an academic before he became the President of India.”

“My cousin is the only person in the family who wanted to be an academic. Now tell me, what is the meaning of the word ‘academician’?”

“Usually when you refer to someone as being an ‘academician’, it implies that he/she is a member of an academy or a society...”

“...any type of academy?”

“An academician is usually a member of an academy that is concerned with the arts or sciences. The Royal Academy of Arts, for instance, or the Russian Academy of Sciences.”

“I think I understand the difference now. A professor is an academic. And when that professor becomes a member of an academy which is devoted to either the sciences or the arts, then he becomes an ‘academician’.”

“Absolutely!”

Published in The Hindu on July 3, 2001

THE DAILY QUIZ

American novelist Toni Morrison passed away on this day in 2019. Here is a quiz on one of the critically acclaimed authors of contemporary American literature

Sindhu Nagaraj

QUESTION 1

In which year was she awarded the Nobel Prize in Literature?

QUESTION 2

In 1988, Morrison won the Pulitzer Prize for which of her works?

QUESTION 3

Morrison became the first Black female editor for fiction at which publishing house in New York?

QUESTION 4

In her capacity as an editor, she published two

groundbreaking works. One was of a boxing champion, titled ‘The Greatest: My Own Story’ and the other of a little-known novelist and poet who in 1968 had been shot to death by a transit officer in the New York City Subway. Name both the figures.

QUESTION 5

Which writer, upon Morrison’s death said, “Morrison rejected the very concept of the narrow door and claimed for herself the wide world. All readers and writers are indebted to her for the space she created”?



Visual question: Identify this boy on whom Toni Morrison wrote her first play on. The boy was abducted and lynched in Mississippi in 1955. AP

Questions and answers to the previous day’s daily quiz: 1. Of the 122 athletes who represented India, 38 returned with 39 medals with one of them getting two (a silver and bronze). Name this champion. **Ans: Gulveer Singh** 2. In para athletics, six medals came from three events thanks to three double podiums of which two were a top-two finish. Name the events. **Ans: Women’s and men’s shot put F57 and the men’s 100m T47** 3. Name the first medallist and the first to strike gold for India at the Games. **Ans: Jhandu Kumar (para powerlifting) and Mirabai Chanu (weightlifting)** 4. Apart from boxing, India won two gold medals in this sport, for the first-ever such success for the country at the Games. **Ans: Judo through Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh** 5. Name the compatriots of Neeraj Chopra and Praveen Chithravel who claimed bronze when the duo won silver in their disciplines. **Ans: Yash Vir Singh (javelin) and Selva Prabhu (triple jump)** 6. This gold medallist was the flag-bearer at the Closing Ceremony of the Games. **Ans: Jaismine Lamboria** 7. The youngest member of India’s contingent also brought the curtains down on India’s campaign. Name the teenager. **Ans: Lisha Das** Visual: Name this athlete who won his event with a Games record. **Ans: Dilip Mahadu Gavit** Early bird: Prem Raj P.



Please send in your answers to
dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Word of the day

Capricious:

determined by chance or impulse rather than necessity or reason

Synonyms: impulsive, whimsical

Usage: She displayed a capricious disposition, shifting from warmth to aloofness in moments.

Pronunciation: newsth.live/capricious

International Phonetic

Alphabet: /kəˈpɪʃəs/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to letters@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Text & Context’

Parliament
clears Bill on
births, deaths
registration

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Rajya Sabha on Tuesday passed the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill, 2026 amid protests by Opposition members demanding an apology from Union Home Minister Amit Shah for the police action against student protesters. The Bill proposes to amend sub-section (3) of Section 13 of the present Act to make provisions of delayed registration more stringent.

Mr. Shah had said in the statement of objects and reasons of the Bill that the amendment would encourage timely reporting of event of birth and death.

Minister of State for Home, Nityanand Rai, said the Bill was a result of the Narendra Modi government's commitment that every child born in the country be registered and every death recorded.

Earlier, the Opposition demanded Mr. Shah's presence during the discussion of a Bill moved by his Ministry. Certain amendments moved by the Opposition MPs were defeated.

Opposition seeks debate on
temple theft, police action

Mallikarjun Kharge says govt. 'seems panicked' and the 'truth will come out' if there is a debate on the Ram Mandir issue and police brutality against students; INDIA bloc members stage protest

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

With the Opposition intensifying protests over the Ram Temple donation scam and its demand for a statement from Home Minister Amit Shah on the police action against protesters in Delhi on July 20, the Rajya Sabha failed to function in the first half of Tuesday, even as the two sides traded barbs on the issues.

The day began with Leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha, Mallikarjun Kharge, demanding a response from Prime Minister Narendra Modi on the theft of valuables donated to the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, considering that the Centre had constituted the Trust, allotted 70 acres of land for the construction of the temple, and Mr. Modi had inaugurated the temple.

Responding to this, Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said the Opposition is always keen to



The Leader of Opposition in the Rajya Sabha, Mallikarjun Kharge, speaks during the Monsoon Session of Parliament on Tuesday. PTI

speak but never interested in listening. "This is not acceptable... this House belongs to all members, not only to the Leader of the Opposition," he said.

DMK floor leader Tiruchi Siva aired his party's protest over the arrest of its leader Udayanidhi Stalin. "Freedom of expression ensured in the Constitution is not being implemented in Tamil Nadu... it has been curtailed. The Leader of the Opposition in the State Assembly, Mr. Udayanidhi Stalin, was arrested for addressing a

public rally," he said. His comments were cut short by Chairman C.P. Radhakrishnan, who pointed out that it was a State subject and could not be taken up.

The House ran for another eight minutes amid loud protests before Mr. Radhakrishnan adjourned it to meet at noon. Similar scenes were repeated when the House reconvened. Opposition members stood at the very rim of the Well of the House, raising slogans against the government.

Speaking to pressper-

sons in the Parliament complex, Mr. Kharge said the Opposition wanted a discussion in both Houses on the Ram Temple row and the police action against students.

"We want the Chairman and the Speaker to allow a discussion. If there is a debate on the Ram Mandir donation theft and the brutality against students, the truth will come out on its own. But for some reason, the government seems panicked," he said. "Either they are scared, or by not coming to the House, they want to insult Parliament," he added, alleging that Mr. Modi and Mr. Shah were avoiding accountability.

Members of the INDIA bloc staged a demonstration outside Parliament entrance, holding up a poster asking, "Why is Amit Shah absent from Parliament?" Among those who joined the protest were Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Trinamool Congress MP Sagarika Ghose, and Rashtriya Janata Dal MP Manoj Jha.

NCP demands apology
from Congress over social
media post on Sunetra

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

A Congress social media post calling Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) president and Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister, Sunetra Pawar, a "gungi gudiya (dumb doll)" sparked a political row on Tuesday

The NCP demanded an immediate apology from the Congress, asking leaders Sonia Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra if they endorsed the sexist comments and whether the party would condemn them. The term had once been used to mock Indira Gandhi in her early days as Prime Minister.

Maharashtra Cabinet Ministers Chhagan Bhujbal and Narhari Zhirwal lashed out at the Congress, while NCP workers hit the streets and forcibly entered the Congress office in Colaba in Mumbai, shouting slogans against the party. Ms. Pawar herself said little, telling presspersons that she would "speak at the right time".

The controversy erupted after the Congress post-



Sunetra Pawar

ed a video on Monday, of Ms. Pawar's recent press conference in Beed, where a journalist's question on the deteriorating law and order situation in the district was allegedly stopped midway. Ms. Pawar, the Guardian Minister of Beed, was seen getting up to walk away from the press conference as the journalist is stopped by NCP leader Dhananjay Munde.

After the video of the press conference went viral, the Congress posted it on its social media handle and asked, "For how many days will Sunetra Pawar continue to remain a 'gungi gudiya' or a 'dumb doll'?"

The State Congress defended the post, calling the NCP workers' behaviour 'thuggery', and asking NCP leaders to quit politics if

they cannot take criticism.

"Sunetra Pawar should prove that she is a 'Durga' by seeking the Finance department [portfolio] from the BJP, by allocating ₹2,100 instead of ₹1,500 in the Ladki Bahin Yojana, as was promised by her late husband Ajit Pawar," Maharashtra Congress president Harshwardhan Sapkal said.

The NCP also dragged Congress ally and NCP (SP) chief Sharad Pawar into the controversy.

NCP Maharashtra vice-president Udaykumar Aher said the Congress had insulted not just Ms. Pawar, but the entire Pawar family. "Sharad Pawar *saaheb* should force the Congress to publicly apologise to Sunetra *vahini*. Otherwise he should exit the INDIA bloc," he said. Mr. Sharad Pawar is the uncle of Ms. Sunetra Pawar's late husband Ajit Pawar.

Asking Congress to revoke the statement, NCP leader Umesh Patil said that while political criticism is healthy in a democracy, it should not mean demeaning women.

Students in 'severe pain'
need apology, not PM's
'forgiveness': Rahul Gandhi

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Tuesday said students protesting across the country were in "severe pain" over unemployment and the state of the education system, and did not need Prime Minister Narendra Modi's "forgiveness" but an apology for his government's actions against them.

Mr. Gandhi was speaking at the launch of a book on former MP and Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK) chief Vaiko, *Vaiko in Parliament*. He said students had taken to the streets demanding fairness in examinations and a functioning education system.

"They don't have work and are asking for fairness in exams and an education system that works. On the other hand, the Prime Minister is forgiving them. Who is he to forgive them? Where does he get this idea that he can forgive the future of India? They don't need his forgiveness; they deserve an apology," he said.

Mr. Gandhi linked the



For country's future: MDMK chief Vaiko and other leaders during the book launch of *Vaiko in Parliament*. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

student protests to what he described as the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS)'s attempt to impose a single historical narrative on the country.

Citing the Constitution's description of India as a "Union of States", he said every State embodied the history, traditions, language, and aspirations of its people. "When you say Tamil Nadu, inside it is the history of the Tamil people — their pain, suffering and happiness. Every State has the right to express its own culture and language," he said.

'RSS trampling history'
Alleging that the RSS believed that only the history "ascribed by it" mattered, he added: "This is why the

students are out on the streets. India will not tolerate its history being trampled upon by anybody."

Among those present at the event were former Finance Minister P. Chidambaram, TNCC chief Manickam Tagore, Tamil Nadu Education Minister A. Rajmohan, CPI(M) general secretary M.A. Baby, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, CPI general secretary D. Raja, former J&K Chief Minister Farooq Abdullah, Shiv Sena (UBT) MP Sanjay Raut, and others.

Describing Mr. Vaiko as "an inspiration for all of us", Mr. Gandhi thanked the veteran leader for his service to the country and said it was an honour to participate in the launch of his book.

Voting age
should be
reduced to
16: Dipankar

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The voting age in the country should be reduced from the current 18 to 16, CPI(ML) Liberation general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya said on Tuesday.

His remarks came against the backdrop of reports that RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat would address around 2,000 students aged between 15 and 19 at Mumbai's Nita Mukesh Ambani Centre on Thursday. Calling the event a "desperate" attempt to reach out to Gen Z, Mr. Bhattacharya said its scale was "impressive" but questioned its purpose, more so considering the "apologies being forced out of students". Accusing Prime Minister Narendra Modi of "invoking patriarchal prejudices against India's 'misled' daughters", Mr. Bhattacharya said "the orchestrated backlash [against student protests] is forcing 15-year-olds to offer apology videos".

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Mr. Bhattacharya said if the Centre and the RSS were indeed keen to listen to Gen Z, then they should allow its members to make their voices heard through the ballot.

Govt. efforts since 2014 paid
off in sports arena: Minister

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The National Democratic Alliance (NDA)'s Parliamentary Party group on Tuesday held its customary weekly meeting during the Monsoon Session of Parliament, with presentations on the performance of India's sportspersons in the recently concluded Commonwealth Games and on employment opportunities for the young. The meeting took place against the backdrop of the recent Gen Z protests.

The meeting, helmed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, was attended by several Union Ministers, including Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Home Minister Amit Shah, Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, and External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar, and MPs from the Bharati-



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah, and BJP president Nitin Nabin at the NDA meeting on Tuesday. ANI

ya Janata Party (BJP) and other NDA allies. BJP president Nitin Nabin was seen sitting next to Mr. Modi at the meeting, held a day after the party was defeated in the byelection to the Bankipur Assembly seat in Bihar.

Union Minister for Youth Affairs and Sports, Mansukh Mandaviya, gave a presentation on India's achievements in sports. The policies adopted by the NDA government since

2014 had resulted in the country securing many awards, with gold medals in international events, he reportedly said. Mr. Mandaviya, who also holds the Labour and Employment portfolio, said, "Between 2004 and 2014, when the UPA was in power, only 2.89 crore youth got jobs, while between 2014 and 2026, 17.1 crore youth secured employment," according to an MP present at the meeting.

M.P. schedules
student union
polls in Sept.

The Hindu Bureau
BHOPAL

The Madhya Pradesh government has told the High Court that student union elections in higher educational institutions will be held in September, ending a nine-year gap.

Hearing petitions on Monday seeking elections in colleges and universities, a Division Bench of Acting Chief Justice Vivek Rusa and Justice Pradeep Mittal noted that the 2026-27 academic calendar scheduled the polls for September.

"In the said Academic Calendar, the month of September 2026 has been fixed for conducting the Student Body Elections (Chhatra Sangathan)," the court said. It also directed the authorities to hold elections in every college of the State.

'Bihar Police action poses a
grave threat to democracy'

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

The Bihar Police used gun fire, tear gas, and lathis against student protesters following the mandatory legal procedures for the use of force, according to a Congress fact-finding team's preliminary report.

Discussing the report at a press conference in Patna on Tuesday, Congress leader Kanhaiya Kumar, who is the national in-charge for the party's student wing, the National Students Union of India (NSUI), said the police brutality unco-

Congress leader
demands a judicial
inquiry into the
police action during
student protests

vered in the report is a threat to democracy in the State.

Mr. Kumar alleged that the police blatantly disregarded the law and police manuals in their attempt to crush peaceful student protests across various districts, and called for a fair, judicial inquiry into the police actions. The fact-

finding team visited several districts, including Patna, Siwan, Jehanabad, Bhagalpur, and Darbhanga.

He alleged that the police used excessive force in firing on students in Siwan with AK-47 guns, adding that there were also allegations regarding the use of inappropriate weapons for crowd control.

"Bihar is the land of democracy, and any attempt to transform it into a regime of police rule or 'lathi-tantra' (rule by the baton) would not be accepted at any cost," Mr. Kumar said.



जवाहरलाल स्नातकोत्तर आयुर्विज्ञान शिक्षा एवं अनुसंधान संस्थान
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No.JPADMIN-1REC03(1)/17/2026
Dated: 03.08.2026

The Director, JIPMER, invites applications from eligible officers of Central/State/U.T. Governments/Statutory/Autonomous Bodies/Government Universities/Government Research and Development Organizations, etc., for filling the various **Group A & B posts on Deputation basis at JIPMER, Puducherry, and JIPMER, Karaikal, given as detailed below:**

JIPMER, Puducherry			
Sl. No	Name of the post	Pay Level (7th CPC)	Vacancy
1.	Controller of Examinations	Level – 12	1
2.	Registrar	Level – 12	1
3.	System Analyst	Level – 11	2
4.	Computer Programmer	Level – 10	2
5.	Purchase Officer	Level – 10	1
6.	Data Processing Assistant Grade A	Level – 7	1
7.	Assistant Registrar	Level – 7	1

JIPMER, Karaikal			
Sl. No	Name of the post	Pay Level (7th CPC)	Vacancy
8.	Registrar	Level – 12	1
9.	Assistant Controller of Examinations	Level – 10	1
10.	Computer Programmer	Level – 10	1
11.	Accounts Officer	Level – 9	1
12.	Assistant Registrar	Level – 7	2

The format of the application, other details regarding pay scale, age, qualification, experience, and other conditions of eligibility, etc., for the above posts are available on the JIPMER website **"www.jipmer.edu.in"**.
The last date for receipt of the filled-in application is **21:09:2026 (Monday), up to 4:30 P.M.**

DIRECTOR





GOVERNMENT OF PUDUCHERRY
DEPARTMENT OF TOURISM
Dr. Ambedkar Salai, Uppalam, Puducherry – 605001
Ph: 0413-2358570, 2358573; Email: pondytourism@gmail.com

e-TENDER NOTICE
REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

Tender ID: 2026_DoT_22631_1
Date: 04.08.2026

The Department of Tourism, Government of Puducherry invites online e-Tenders from eligible and experienced firms to develop, operate, maintain and management of digitally equipped museum and allied tourism facilities on Design, Build, Finance, Operate and Transfer (DBFOT) basis at Murugapakkam, Puducherry.

The detailed Request for Proposal (RFP) containing eligibility criteria, scope of work, concession terms, bid schedule and other conditions is available on the Government e-Procurement Portal. Tender documents can be downloaded from **https://pudutenders.gov.in**. The bidders should submit their technical and financial bids through online in **https://pudutenders.gov.in**. Tenders submitted in any other forms will not be accepted.

Last Date & Time for Submission of Bids is 21.09.2026, 03.00 p.m. The undersigned reserves the right either to accept or to reject any or all the tenders and postpone the due date without assigning any reason thereof.

No. 146/DIP/AD(PRESS)/ADVT/2026-27
DIRECTOR OF TOURISM

CM

M ND-NDE

Three Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) personnel died in a suspected case of fratricide at a camp in central Assam's Nagaon district on Tuesday. Officials said Assistant Sub-Inspector (ASI) Ballani Premabaram from Andhra Pradesh shot himself after firing at Head Constable Vishnu Prasad Baghel and Sub-Inspector Ramnawal Singh Yadav. The latter died on the spot, while the former succumbed to his injuries later. The CRPF authorities and the Nagaon police have launched an investigation to ascertain the circumstances of the case.

A. M. Jigeesh
NEW DELHI

In a meeting of the Employees State Insurance Corporation (ESIC) held in New Delhi on Tuesday, employees' representatives demanded that the Centre increase the wage limit to qualify for ESIC benefits to at least ₹30,000 from the present figure of ₹21,000. Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, who chaired the meeting, told the trade union members that the government is "considering" the proposal and a decision will be taken soon.

Talking to *The Hindu* after the meeting, Bharatiya Mazdoor Sangh's (BMS) representative in the ESIC Board, S. Durairaj, said if the government raises the ceiling, the ESIC can provide coverage to more than 50 lakh workers, apart from the 3.8 crore people insured at present.

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

Three widely prescribed medicines used to treat high blood pressure, fungal infections, and organ transplant rejection have been classified as “carcinogenic to humans” (Group I) by the International Agency for Research on Cancer (IARC), the World Health Organization (WHO)’s cancer research agency.

Experts said the classification is a hazard identification and should not prompt patients to discontinue treatment without consulting their doctors.

The three medicines – hydrochlorothiazide (hypertension), voriconazole (fungal infections), and tacrolimus (an immunosuppressant preventing transplant rejection) – are on the WHO Model List of Es-

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court orally clarified on Tuesday that a direction banning mining activities within a 10-km radius of the Asan wetland conservation reserve, a Ramsar site in Uttarakhand, would apply to other wetland reserves across the country for the sake of parity.

“Wherever it is a community or a wetland conservation reserve, Asan [directions] will be applied. Wetlands are in a different category... We are conscious of the extent to which we are laying down parity. It is not that it [directions] would apply to Madhya Pradesh or would apply to West Bengal only,” Justice Joymalya Bagchi, part of the Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, observed.

The court was hearing a petition filed by Himachal Pradesh saying the restriction imposed in Uttarakhand should not apply to it. “The entire Himalayan terrain has to be governed by the same set of directions. The only exception can be if an expert committee says the reserve is not in your State,” the CJI addressed the State.

13 Indian nationals among those rescued; New Delhi strongly condemns attack, says the targeting of commercial shipping in the region must end

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

An Indian-flagged merchant vessel sank off the coast of Yemen on Tuesday after being hit by a projectile, the External Affairs Ministry said. All 14 crew members, including 13 Indians, were rescued.

Union Shipping Minister Sarbananda Sonowal said the vessel was hit by a projectile near Yemeni waters, causing the vessel to capsize and sink.

New Delhi condemned the attack and said targeting of commercial shipping in the region must stop.

"We condemn the attack on the Indian-flagged commercial vessel, *MSV Faize Noore Oliya* that sank in the Red Sea, off the coast of Yemen on August 4," the Ministry said.

"Our Embassy in Riyadh is closely monitoring the situation and proactively coordinating with the Yemeni authorities for the safety and security of the crew," it added.

The safety of our people is our supreme priority: I am relieved to inform that all 14 seafarers (including 13 Indians) have been safely rescued by the Yemeni Coast Guard and brought to the port of Mokha

SARBANANDA SONOWAL
Union Shipping Minister

The Ministry thanked the Yemeni authorities for their support in rescuing the Indians.

“The continuing incidents of attacks on commercial shipping in the region are deeply worrisome,” it said.

“The targeting of commercial shipping in the region must end, and free and unimpeded navigation and commerce through the international waterways in the region, in keeping with international law, must be restored at the earliest,” the Ministry said in a statement.

In a social media post, Mr. Sonowal said India

strongly condemned the "unprovoked attack" on the ship.

"The safety of our people is our supreme priority; I am relieved to inform that ALL 14 seafarers (including 13 Indians) have been safely rescued by the Yemeni Coast Guard and brought to the Port of Mokha," he added.

Mr. Sonowal said he had instructed the Director General Maritime Administration (DGMA) to take immediate steps in coordination with all agencies to ensure the security of Indian seafarers in the region and provide all necessary assistance to rescued crew.

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Tuesday extended the mandatory third-party motor insurance coverage of new vehicles by a year. New cars will now have four years of coverage and two-wheelers of six years, it said.

The court observed that despite the statutory mandate, a "shocking" number of vehicles continued to ply on Indian roads without third-party insurance, forcing accident victims and their families to "run from pillar to post" to secure compensation.

"While the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) and the General Insurance Council (GIC) have recommended that this period not be enhanced, we are of the view that it is in the interest of road safety that the period be en-



The court said that despite the mandate, vehicles continued to ply without insurance.

hanced by one year. Therefore, it is directed that henceforth, third-party insurance for four years for new cars and six years for new two-wheelers be required to be purchased. IRDA to immediately issue necessary directions," a Bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and Prashant Kumar Mishra said.

In its 2018 judgment in the *S. Rajasekaran v. Union of India* case, the top court had required purchasers of new vehicles to obtain three-year third-party insurance for cars

				1	4	9		7
						4		
9		4			6	3	1	
				6	3	8	9	
	3	2	5	8				
	4	1	3			6		5
		5						
8		3	1	2				

Solution to previous puzzle

M	A	L	D				A	X	T
S	I	R	L	O	N		D	E	L
O	U	A	T	C		T	G	R	A
N		S	N					E	S
S	N							O	A
C	H	I	C	K	E	N	K		
U			U	D	C		E		P
S	L	U	M		K	N	E	E	L
E	A	L			R	E			
S			C	A	U	G	H	T	
S	H	X	E					S	H
S	H	R	I	E	K		A	T	H
S	S		S	L	D			U	L
B	E	S	M	E	A	R		S	L
D	O	N						A	D

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

4	8	3	2	5	6	9	7	1
6	2	9	1	7	4	8	5	3
7	1	5	3	9	8	6	2	4
8	9	2	6	3	5	4	1	7
3	4	6	7	1	9	5	8	2
1	5	7	8	4	2	3	6	9
5	3	8	4	2	7	1	9	6
9	7	4	5	6	1	2	3	8
2	6	1	9	8	3	7	4	5

Sage Dhaumya's advice

Yudhishthira was worried because many sadhus insisted on following the Pandavas to the forest, and he did not have the wherewithal to provide food for them. He asked sage Dhaumya for advice. Dhaumya asked Yudhishthira to worship the Sun, said Kidambi Narayanan in a discourse. He described the greatness of the Sun. When animals suffer without food, Surya absorbs water in the ocean during the Uttarayana period. During Dakshinayana, he gives the moisture back to the earth as rain. Rain causes plants and vegetation to thrive. Thus, animals obtain food. Since Surya is responsible for sustaining all life, he should be worshipped, said Dhaumya. He further told Yudhishthira that a ruler must know what his subjects needed. A teacher must be concerned about the welfare of his students; the head of a family must be concerned about the welfare of his family and a king about the welfare of his subjects.

Dhaumya reassured Yudhishthira that by following dharma he could serve the sadhus who were with him. He taught Yudhishthira a mantra to worship Surya. Yudhishthira recited the mantra, keeping his mind under control. Pleased with his worship, Surya appeared before Yudhishthira. Yudhishthira praised him thus: “You are like the eyes of this world. You are the *atma* of every living thing. Unhealthy plants recover when the Sun’s rays fall on them. You are the cause for the five elements. While you support and purify the world, you expect nothing in return. Your chariot is followed by sages and celestials. The celestials get their positions only through your grace. You have *tejas* [effulgence], *dharma*, *jnana* and *aishwarya*. Your *tejas* appears as thunder and lightning.”



Union Minister of Civil Aviation K. Rammohan Naidu visits an injured passenger at a hospital in New Delhi. PTI

17 injured as Air India flight hits turbulence

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

Thirteen passengers and four crew members on an Air India flight to Delhi from Phuket in Thailand sustained injuries on Tuesday after the aircraft encountered turbulence along its way, leading to a sudden drop in altitude.

The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) is investigating the incident.

The aircraft hit turbulence during the cruise phase of the flight that resulted "in a momentary change in altitude", Air India said. Flight tracking website Flightradar 24 showed a 300-foot-drop around two-and-a-half hours into the flight, while the aircraft was over Odisha.

"After the momentary event, the aircraft conti-

nued normally and landed safely in Delhi at 11:07 hrs IST", the airline spokesperson said. The videos of the incident went viral on social media.

The Airbus A320 aircraft has been grounded following the incident and "the flight data recorder and cockpit voice recorder have been secured for examination", the Civil Aviation Ministry said in a statement.

The injured passengers and crew members were taken to hospital for medical evaluation. Later, five passengers were discharged, while the remaining individuals continued to receive treatment and care. There were total 137 passengers aboard.

Civil Aviation Minister K. Rammohan Naidu visited Fortis and Medanta hospitals to meet the injured.



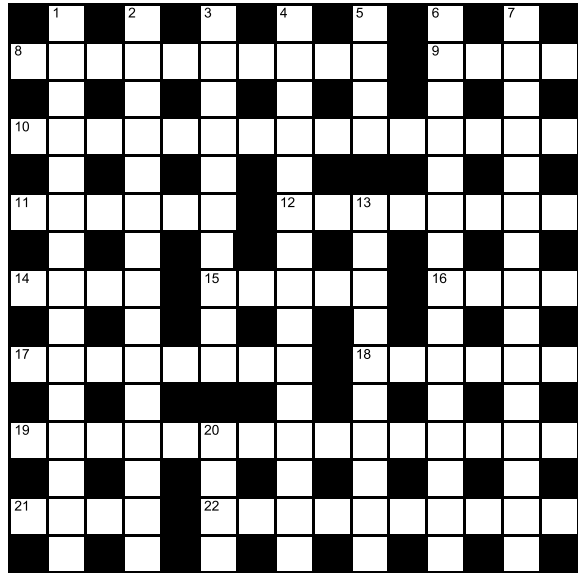
CROSSWORD

14864

(set by Vidwan)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>





Across

- A purer gent styled in an engrossing novel (4-6)
- Missing nothing, only killing by a wild cat (4)
- Harry renounced truth about English criminal (5-3-7)
- Small side around river or brook (6)
- Looks after terms of service for drunkards (8)

- Basic unit in Excel layout! (4)
- Bleak day's back (5)
- Time to run with English knight for expedition (4)
- Drive of the majority wanting small personal sacrifices! Public relations! (8)
- Chinese silk cloth from some sponge extract (6)
- Bury to pass stage one at England, amongst universities (15)
- Untidiness of officer's eating place (4)
- Work during days, more confident about following one who sails on board (10)

Down

- Done with parent shifts! Taking time to have fun in open! (5,3,4,3)
- Seen as a relieved kind of affliction (8,7)
- Head's cut time to call, left out AV, for example (10)
- Bug checker with nil pretences! Let about! (6,9)
- So involved in greater good (4)
- Ambassador of India, powerful in general (15)
- Heard 'Nehru' tweet translated poorly (5,3,7)
- Demi Moore's movie lines, model for cold naturalness (10)
- Intimidate with large hood (4)

Transport, pharma and biotech become India’s biggest research investors

Jacob P. Koshy
NEW DELHI

India’s private-sector research effort is now being driven overwhelmingly by the transportation, pharmaceutical, biotechnology and information technology (IT) industries, with transport companies emerging as the country’s largest corporate R&D investors, according to the Department of Science and Technology’s (DST) Research and Development Statistics 2025-26.

The report also shows that industry now employs more researchers than the public sector in core R&D

activities, underscoring a broader shift in the country’s innovation landscape.

The report follows a disclosure by the DST in the Lok Sabha last week that showed India’s spending on research and development (R&D) surged to 0.83% of GDP in 2021-22, the first time that the country crossed the 0.8% threshold since 2009-10.

The report estimates that India’s R&D expenditure will approach 0.9% of GDP in 2025-26.

The figures also reveal a structural shift in India’s innovation landscape: private industry accounted for 45.5% of national R&D

spending in 2021-22, rising further to 51.8% in 2023-24, the first time businesses have contributed more to India’s research effort than all levels of government combined.

Transportation companies spent ₹39,137 crore on R&D in 2023-24, making them the single largest industrial R&D contributor, followed by drugs and pharmaceuticals (₹25,847 crore), biotechnology (₹10,321 crore), IT (₹9,587 crore) and electrical and electronics (₹6,779 crore).

Together, these sectors accounted for the bulk of private industrial research expenditure.



Transportation companies spent ₹39,137 crore on R&D in 2023-24.

The latest figures represent a marked departure from the pattern seen in the last publicly available DST statistical compendium released in 2020, which contained data up to

2018-19. At that time, pharma and transportation were already among the country’s leading industrial research sectors, but transportation R&D was only about ₹14,000 crore while biotechnology and IT accounted for a much smaller share of industrial research spending.

Since then, the transport-sector R&D has almost tripled, biotechnology has emerged as one of India’s largest research-intensive industries, and IT has joined the country’s leading corporate R&D spenders.

An official, who declined to be identified but

familiar with the data compendium, attributed the sharp rise in private sector spending to “post COVID.”

The “realisation” that investments in R&D were “critical” to companies’ future prompted greater investments, he told *The Hindu*. Though nearly 8,000-odd companies populated the DST database, 90% of the R&D investments came from 500-odd companies.

He underlined that the DST had not made any methodological changes to how it sourced this data from industries, which is done through self-reported questionnaires. Stricter re-

quirements by RBI on transparently disclosing R&D spends may also have played a role, he added.

The expansion in spending has been accompanied by a shift in India’s research workforce. The latest survey estimates that private industry employed more full-time equivalent (FTE) R&D personnel than government institutions in 2023-24, with business enterprises accounting for the largest pool of researchers and technical staff engaged in core research activities. In contrast, the 2020 edition of the report, based on 2017-18 data, showed govern-

ment institutions, including central agencies, state organisations and higher educational institutions, as the dominant employers of India’s R&D workforce.

The report attributes the increase in private research primarily to business enterprises rather than private universities or research organisations.

Of the ₹1.27 lakh crore spent by the private sector in 2023-24, private industry accounted for ₹1.11 lakh crore, while Scientific and Industrial Research Organisations contributed ₹7,798 crore and private higher educational institutions ₹9,164 crore.

INBRIEF



LIC shares dip 8% on Centre’s stake sale at 10% discount

Investors sold Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) pulling it down by almost 8% on the BSE, closing at more than a two-month low of ₹391/share after the government sold its stake at 10% discount. The stock hit ₹400/apiece before steadily sliding and reaching the day’s close. The Centre sold 6.5% stake in LIC via OFS at a discount of 10% . LIC’s offer for sale consisted of a base offer of up to 2% equity stake in the insurer with an option to sell an additional 4.5% stake. The offer for sale (OFS) comes four years after LIC’s initial public offering (IPO), which had fetched ₹21,000 crore for a 3.5% stake.

ONGC’s net profit more than doubles to ₹17,034 crore

Oil and Natural Gas Corporation’s (ONGC) net profit more than doubled in the June ended quarter, fuelled by a more-than-a-half time increase in net crude price realisations. Net profit rose more than 112% on a year-on-year basis to ₹17,034 crore. This was led by net crude oil price realisations, that is, the average price an explorer receives for each barrel of oil it sells, increasing 50.4% to \$99.45 per barrel. Gross revenue increased 45.2% YoY to ₹46,460 crore. Standalone production of crude oil and natural gas stayed nearly flat in the reported quarter from the comparable period last year at 4.452 MMT and 4.756 billion cubic metres (BCM).

FSSAI bans ‘100% pure’ Dabur products, firm’s share falls 4%

Labels such as ‘100% pure, natural, organic and tender’ are in contravention of food safety regulations, as they are ambiguous, unverifiable and likely to mislead consumers, says regulator

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

In a major clamp down on companies making false and misleading claims, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has issued an order directing FMCG major Dabur India Ltd. to withdraw products carrying ‘misleading 100% claims’.

The regulator issued notice to the company to withdraw such products from the market with immediate effect and report the action taken, in 15 days.

The order is against the company’s food products which include honey, apple cider vinegar, virgin coconut oil, sesame oil, cow ghee, coconut water, and coconut milk.

Stating that several critical non-compliances had been observed, FSSAI said, “Food products being sold on the company’s website were found carrying misleading “100%” claims such as “100% Natural”, “100% Pure”, “100% Purity Guaranteed”, “100% Organic” and “100% Tender”.

“The use of the 100% claims are in contravention



Block list: The order is against Dabur products including honey, apple cider vinegar, virgin coconut oil, and cow ghee. FILE PHOTO

of the FSS (Advertising & Claims) Regulations, 2018, as they are ambiguous, unverifiable and likely to mislead consumers,” the regulator said on X.

It said Dabur Himalayan Organic Apple Cider Vinegar and Dabur Organic Honey were found displaying the Jaivik Bharat Logo without valid FSSAI organic endorsement, in contravention of the FSS (Organic Foods) Regulations, 2017.

“Dabur Hommade Coconut Milk was marketed with the claim “100% Purity”. Such a claim is not permissible for compound foods under the FSS (Advertising & Claims) Regulations, 2018, FSSAI said.

Despite an earlier notice directing discontinuation of misleading “100%”

stands by the purity and quality of its products and has never made any misleading claims,” it stated.

The company said it was exploring options in relation to the prohibitory order. “However, as a good corporate citizen, Dabur had already initiated transition of the product labels as mentioned in the FSSAI letter to new labels/advertisements without the 100% claim,” it said.

‘In transition’

“Most product labels/advertisements/website as mentioned in aforesaid order, have either already transitioned or are in the process of transition. The company is responding accordingly to FSSAI and will continue to engage constructively with them to resolve the matter,” it added.

“We reiterate that Dabur stands by the purity and highest standards of quality of its products and does not make any misleading claims,” it emphasised.

The company said the order would have limited impact on its business operations, financial position or performance and be confined to the food products under objection.

Govt. introduces Bill to ‘make it easier to do business in India’

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday introduced the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 in the Lok Sabha, seeking to amend several existing Acts in a bid to attract more foreign capital, make it easier to do business in India, and to push the Make in India mission.

The Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 will amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, Income-Tax Act, 2025, and the Finance Act, 2026.

The Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 seeks to amend several existing Acts

The Bill proposes a key tax exemption for data centres in India.

“Foreign cloud companies that use Indian data centres were earlier promised a tax exemption, but with conditions of clearing several layers of government notification and approval,” a Finance Ministry official explained.

The proposed Bill seeks to remove these approval requirements. In addition, it will allow Indian data centres to be run on a leased basis rather than only under direct ownership. “Global investment funds are typically run by skilled fund managers, and

India has deep talent in this field,” the official further explained. “Until now, a long and demanding list of conditions discouraged those managers from basing themselves in India, for fear that doing so might make the entire foreign fund taxable here.”

The proposed Bill seeks to slash this list of conditions, retaining only those that are expressly aimed at preventing misuse and round-tripping of money by Indians. Under the proposed rules, fund managers will be allowed to relocate to India without the foreign fund being treated as doing business in India.

Dividends paid by REITs and InvITs to their investors were tax free only if the operating company stayed in the old tax regime. However, as companies increasingly move to the new tax regime, investors risked losing this benefit.

The Bill introduced on Tuesday seeks to restore this exemption.

Wind turbine firms seek export-linked sops, PLI

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

The Indian Wind Turbine Manufacturers Association (IWTMA) has written to the Union Ministry for New and Renewable Energy for an export-linked incentive scheme, Amit Pyasi, CEO told *The Hindu*.

Separately, Mr. Pyasi said industry would receive an additional boost if the Centre could support it with an incentive scheme for indigenous making of flanges and large bearings required in large forging facilities.



Pyasi also mooted a scheme for local making of flanges.

kind of a facility,” he said.

Mr. Pyasi pointed out India’s import needs in this sector relate to forging facilities for larger platforms such as those of about five megawatts.

“We request the Centre to support the industry with incentives for manufacturing large bearings, flanges, which are part of the tower because the forging facility is not there in India,” he said.

On curtailment

Mr. Pyasi said by very nature, solar and wind energy had lower capacity utilisation factor viz. about 21% and 36-40% respectively compared with conventional coal-powered plants with about 85%. Therefore, renewable sources see a wide variance of installed capacity percentage with the final output generated. Curtailment is when power-grid operators limit output from generating sources for grid stability.

“When we look at [power] generation figures, we should be clear it may come across that renewable is not in it but that is not the case, we just need to deploy more capacities,” he added.

Tapping demand

Underscoring the need for export sops, Mr. Pyasi said, “There is a lot of demand for India-manufactured equipment. However, we are not as cost competitive as China as they have an established ecosystem and provide a lot of subsidies to the manufacturing segment.”

Suggesting a structure, he said, “There could be a manufacturer-linked incentive for exports - to be gauged by rupees/megawatt for five to seven years. It could be a turnover-linked incentive applicable only to exports.”

Mr. Pyasi suggested the Centre consider providing export finance as well as a domestic buyer’s facilities that is, a credit facility to those who buy the wind turbines made in India.

Utilise FTAs

He observed Indian manufacturers did not get like-for-like advantage when they sought to approach markets outside India (for example, Europe or North America) compared with neighbouring countries supplying equipment to India.

“We request the government to negotiate with counterparts in Europe especially now that the European Union FTA is under discussion, it is probably the opportune time to approach with this



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STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

(₹ in Crores)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone		Consolidated	
		Quarter ended	Year ended	Quarter ended	Year ended
		30.06.2026	30.06.2025	30.06.2026	30.06.2025
		(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)
1	Total Revenue from Operations	1,614.76	1,350.17	1,846.07	1,533.39
2	Net Profit for the period (before tax and exceptional item)	203.23	185.68	223.54	199.13
3	Net Profit for the period (before tax)	203.23	185.68	223.54	199.13
4	Net Profit for the period (after tax)	150.97	138.35	168.69	147.94
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	151.97	139.87	175.88	155.27
6	Equity Share Capital (Face Value of Re 1/- each fully paid up)	21.01	21.01	21.01	21.01
7	Earnings Per Share (EPS) (for continuing and discontinued operations) (Face value of Re 1/- each) (not annualised) (in Rs.)				
	(a) Basic	7.18	6.58	8.01	7.06
	(b) Diluted	7.18	6.58	8.01	7.06

* Annualised

Note:

1 The above is an extract of the detailed format of the standalone and consolidated financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites, www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and on the Company's website www.sundram.com. The full financial results can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code provided below.

2 The Statutory Auditors have carried out a limited review for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 and have issued an unmodified review report thereon.



Place : Chennai
Date : August 4, 2026

For Sundram Fasteners Limited
Suresh Krishna
Chairman

Lebanon and Israel hold new round of direct talks in Rome



No Israeli withdrawal from Gaza until Hamas disarmed: Netanyahu



Yemen's Houthis say they attacked airport in southern Saudi Arabia



Ukraine will never join NATO, says former top commander Zaluzhny



'U.S. has used virtually all of its precision missiles during Iran war'

NEW YORK/WASHINGTON

Ship hit, but U.S. hopeful strait deal to be done soon

Dhaka proposes death penalty in enforced disappearance cases

Russian, Ukrainian drone hits kill at least five in each country

Dissanayake says he favours 'national consensus' before drafting Constitution

NOTHING TO BEAT IT

A different kind of happiness, says Sachin on tricolour being hoisted



PTI

When the National flag is hoisted, there is a different kind of happiness. This is what we play for. I want to bring gold from the Asian Games. I want to tell everyone to keep believing and encouraging us — Indian pugilist Sachin Siwach, who won the men’s 60 kg gold at the Commonwealth Games.

AIMING HIGH

Next target is the Asian Games and LA 2028 Olympics: Preeti



PTI

Thank you very much to everyone who came here (at the Delhi airport) to receive us (the boxers). Next target is the Asian Games and LA 2028 Olympics. We cannot express our happiness on hearing the National Anthem play — Preeti Pawar, who bagged the women’s 54kg gold medal in Glasgow.

SPLENDID SHOW

It was a storm of medals: Jhajharia praises para athletes’ performance



FILE PHOTO: SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

This Commonwealth Games was not just a moment; it was a storm of medals for our para athletes. I would like to congratulate all of them. In the last four CWGs, we were only able to win five medals, this time we got seven medals, including three gold — Paralympic Committee of India president Devendra Jhajharia.

BIGGER GOAL

Gavit eyes two Asian Para Games gold after Commonwealth success



PTI

Indian para athlete Dilip Gavt is targeting two Asian Para Games gold medals after a record-breaking win in the 100m T47 event at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. “I am very happy that I competed in the CWG and created a record. I want to win gold in both 100m and 400m at Aichi-Nagoya,” said Gavt.

HI DG fails to respond, SG demands EB meeting

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

The mess in Hockey India keeps getting worse.

On Tuesday, Secretary General (SG) Bholanath Singh reiterated that the Executive Board (EB) was the only forum to resolve all governance issues and sought a meeting to resolve matters.

“For the past few days, mails from you have raised different issues. It is, therefore, requested that all issues may be compiled and put before the EB.

“It is reiterated that the EB is the only competent body to resolve this.

“Please convene an Emergent EB meeting at the earliest,” Bholanath wrote to HI president Dilip Tirkey.

Bholanath has also asked Director General (DG) Cdr. R.K. Srivastava for an explanation on how the media got wind of HI’s internal mails.

“It has come to my notice that the contents of the mail sent by Dilip Tirkey has found place in the media... you are requested to investigate the matter.

“Questions regarding the jersey issue will only be discussed in the HI EB meeting,” he wrote.

No action

This development comes on a day Srivastava failed to provide documentary evidence, despite a strongly worded reminder from Tirkey, for the decision to change the jersey colour.

Humpy keen to make an impression in India’s title defence at Samarkand

I have had to miss quite a few Olympiads in the past, but I am determined to play in this one. We could expect to face strong challenges from Russia, China, Georgia, Kazakhstan and United States’

CHESS OLYMPIAD

P.K. Ajith Kumar
KOZHIKODE

Koneru Humpy wasn’t there when the Indian women won the historic gold at the Chess Olympiad in Budapest in 2024. She will be there though to lead India’s title defence at Samarkand next month.

The presence of two-time World rapid champion has no doubt further strengthened the Indian team. Humpy, one of the strongest female players in history, is looking forward to her return to the Olympiad, after being part of the bronze-medal winning team in the 2022 event, which India had hosted, at Mamallapuram, near Chennai.

“I am really glad to be part of such a strong team at this year’s Olympiad, though I know it is not going to be easy to defend the title,” Humpy told *The Hindu* over the phone from Vijayawada on Tuesday.

“More than winning something for the first time, winning for the second time is usually more difficult.”

Humpy’s teammates in Uzbekistan are Divya Deshmukh, R. Vaishali, Vantika Agrawal and B. Savitha



Task cut out: Humpy feels that winning the crown the second time is tougher. FILE PHOTO

Shri. So India will definitely start as one of the favourites for the title.

“But we could expect to face strong challenges from countries like Russia, China, Georgia, Kazakhstan and the United States,” she said.

“I have had to miss quite a few Olympiads in the past, but I am determined to play in this one, as I am not sure how active as a player I would be when the next one comes after two years.”

Humpy is going to be

pretty active over the next couple of months, though. “I am flying to the US tomorrow for the Cairns Cup at Saint Louis,” she said.

“From there, I will be going to Saint-Tropez in France for the WR Women’s Chess Tour. And then, after spending a few days at home, I will be playing at the Global Chess League in Bengaluru.”

Though the GCL hadn’t gone that well for her last year, the experience helped her to perform well at the World rapid cham-

pionship at Doha, where she had won the bronze after being involved in a three-way tie for the title.

“I was playing at the GCL after a fairly long break, so I wasn’t at my best, but the format of the league proved an excellent preparation for the World rapid championship,” Humpy said.

“The GCL’s rule of having no increment can be tough for the players as we are used to playing with increments in all other tournaments”.

Garaga-Roy duo advances at Korea Masters

BADMINTON

Press Trust of India
ASAN (KOREA)

The unseeded Indian pair of Krishna Prasad Garaga & Pruthvi Krishnamurthy Roy stunned sixth seeded Thai pair of Chaloepon Charoenkitamorn & Worrapol Thongsa-Nga in straight games to enter men’s doubles second round at the Korea Masters Super 300 badminton tournament on Tuesday. The Indian duo took just 42 minutes to get the better of their fancied rivals 21-16, 21-18.

The results: First round: Doubles: Men: Krishna Prasad Garaga & Pruthvi Krishnamurthy Roy bt Chaloepon Charoenkitamorn & Worrapol Thongsa-Nga 21-16, 21-18; Sol Gyu Choi & V. Shem Goh bt Achutaditya Rao Doddavarapu & Arjun Reddy Pochana 21-3, 21-10. **Women:** Ririna Hiramoto & Kokona Ishikawa bt Priya Konjengbam & Shruti Minshra 21-15, 21-13.



Form factor: Five-time medallist Sindhu will take confidence from her maiden Japan Open triumph. FILE PHOTO: SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Satwik-Chirag pair seeded fifth, Sindhu ninth at Worlds

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

Last year’s bronze medal winning pair of R. Satwik-sairaj and Chirag Shetty will be the highest seeded Indians at fifth in the fray at the upcoming BWF World Championships at the Indira Gandhi Stadium here from August 17 to 23.

The two, ranked fifth in the World, are the only Indians besides P.V. Sindhu and Saina Nehwal to win multiple medals in the competition.

Five-time medallist Sindhu — ninth in the world and with a mixed bag so far this year, including a maiden Japan Open title — has been seeded ninth. Former World Championships bronze medallist Lakshya Sen is seeded 14th while the mixed doubles pair of Dhruv Kapila and Tanisha Crasto is seeded 15th.

Defending champion Shi Yuqi of China and South Korea’s An Se Young, meanwhile, will be the top seeds in the men’s and women’s singles respectively.

New scoring system will wipe off a few, benefit others: Gopi Chand

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

P. Gopi Chand still remembers the disruption caused by badminton’s scoring overhaul during his playing career and as the sport gears up to embrace another “tactical shift”, the India coach believes a few players will be “wiped off”.

The 15x3 system (three games of 15 points each) will replace the current 21x3 format (three games of 21 points each) next year. The BWF said the shorter format would help in managing player workload in a crowded calendar.

Gopi Chand recalled how he had won the All England title in 2001 under the traditional 15-point format before badminton briefly switched to the 7x5 scoring system.

“When I won the All England, a few months later they moved from 15 to 7. It took me time because I was one of those players who was a stroke player. I wanted time to get adjust-



Straight talk: Gopi Chand admits India does not have a clear answer to who fill the void once Satwik and Chirag move past their peak. FILE PHOTO: SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

ed. It took me a year to come back,” Gopi Chand said during an interaction ahead of the World Championships.

“And then by the time I was kind of settling in, they brought us back to the long form and it was a death blow.

“Because you train, you detrain, and your endurance drops. Then to go back and play 15 was impossible.

“These definitely make

a big impact. A few players, it will wipe off, a few players might benefit.”

According to the coach, doubles players are likely to feel the biggest impact as shorter games will make every phase of the contest more critical.

Gopi Chand has admitted India does not yet have a clear answer to who fill the men’s doubles void once Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty move past their peak.

Shafique and Babar help Pakistan take lead

Agence France-Presse
PORT OF SPAIN

Abdullah Shafique struck his sixth Test century and Babar Azam fell just short of a hundred as Pakistan scored 387 in reply to West Indies’ 344 on day three of the second Test on Tuesday.

Just days after flying into the Caribbean as an emergency replacement, Shafique remained unbeaten on 160 off 323 balls with 15 fours and three sixes decorating his authoritative innings, which helped the visitor gain a 43-run lead at Queen’s Park Oval.

Jomel Warrican’s superb spell of six for 112 ensured Babar & Co. did not get too far ahead in the match, which looked quite possible when Shafique and Babar (88, 147b, 10x4, 1x6) were batting together.

Babar and the recalled Shafique made the most of ideal batting conditions, gathering runs in style in a third-wicket stand of 183.

On the third morning, Pakistan lost crucial wickets once Babar was run out



Shafique. AFP

by Brandon King as the visitor stumbled from 281 for two to 311 for six. Sajid Khan (30) and Shafique steadied the ship with a 59-run seventh-wicket stand.

However, the Pakistan lower-order could not hold on for much longer once Warrican found his rhythm, losing its last four wickets for 17 runs.

The scores: West Indies 344 in 105.4 overs vs. Pakistan 387 in 115 overs (Azan Awaiz 55, Abdullah Shafique 160 n.o., Babar Azam 88, Jomel Warrican 6/112), **at tea.**

Serena, who last played in Cincinnati in 2022, lifted the singles trophy twice, in 2014 and 2015.

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RS/Hero/08/26



Familiar faces, fresh assignment: French coach Zinedine Zidane, his Italian counterpart Roberto Mancini, German gaffer Jurgen Klopp, and Portuguese manager Jorge Jesus. REUTERS & AP

Football’s managerial carousel is up and running

Legendary midfielder Zidane takes over the French hot seat from Deschamps, Klopp has a huge responsibility with a floundering Germany, as does Mancini with recent under-achiever Italy; Jesus is tasked with guiding Portugal in its quest for the biggest prize

S. Shrivathsan

Mention ‘France head coach’, our muscle memory will instantly direct us to the unassuming figure of Didier Deschamps. After all, he served his role with distinction for as many as 14 years, leading *Les Bleus* to heights only a few football heavyweights have scaled.

During a decade of dominance on the World Cup stage, the 57-year-old masterminded the creation of a second star on the royal blue jersey (2018), had a so-near-yet-so-far moment (2022) and signed off with another semifinal appearance (2026).

Deschamps may not have stayed as cool as a cucumber in the phase that preceded his walk into the sunset – France lost to Spain and England in his last two matches in-charge – but he has left a seat which will remain hot. Occupying the spot will be Zinedine Zidane.

The legendary midfielder has finally landed his dream job after years of wait, and he now has the near-impossible task of bettering or matching his predecessor’s outstanding managerial record. “This is the only job I wanted after my career with Real Madrid (his second stint ended in 2021). I have always looked at this team through the eyes of a future manager,” the 54-year-old said in his first press conference as France chief coach.

Zidane will inherit a richly talented squad that was put together by Deschamps, a master who oversaw multiple transitions in the national team. Excited by the prospect of coaching an “extraordinary” bunch, he began “dreaming” the day he officially took over

Also beginning a new adventure is Belgium boss Mark van Bommel, who takes over from Rudi Garcia

as the boss.

“I am going to ensure continuity so that the French team keeps winning. But we are going to do things differently. Deschamps is Deschamps, [Laurent] Blanc was Blanc and Zizou (his nickname) is Zizou. I am going to do what I know,” he added.

The French Football Federation would not mind the “changes” one bit if he maintains high standards in a result-based business. The long-term ‘goal’, without a doubt, is to recapture the biggest prize four years from now. “It (the role) is a responsibility. Needless to say, I have high ambitions. On the pitch, I was a leader. Now, I am becoming a leader through my experience.”

While Zidane will look to build the blocks to bring home the World Cup, Roberto Mancini, another newly appointed manager, would hope to take his side back to a stage it ruled quite a few times. The latter was not the first choice to fill the vacancy in Italy, which has hit an all-time low after having failed to even make it to the last three World Cups. Mancini’s appointment was overshadowed by the board-room saga that highlighted the mess Italian football finds itself in.

Technical director Paolo Maldini handed in his resignation in a flash – he was roped in only two weeks ago – after it became apparent that his top candidate Andrea Pirlo would not be given the reins. During his brief tenure, Maldini even tried his luck with Pep Guardiola and local



hero Carlo Ancelotti, the current head coach of the Brazil side.

The FIGC, the sport’s governing body in that country, eventually fell back on Mancini, the tactician who guided the Azzurri to the European championship title in 2021.

His return came as a surprise to some, considering that he had left the Italian role for a spell with Saudi Arabia three years ago. “I am very sorry. I am also sorry for everything that has happened over the last three years,” said Mancini, who has replaced Gennaro Gattuso.

Despite the outside noise, he is determined to “bring Italy back to where it belongs.” “I realise that some people will be against me. I am hoping the squad plays well enough so that people forgive me,” added the 61-year-old. A few would suggest that he is hoping against hope, given Italy’s freefall in the last decade.

Like Mancini, Jurgen Klopp has taken up an ultra-challenging project. Germany is nowhere close to being the winning machine it once was, having exited early in each of the last three editions.

Klopp, who was on a sabbatical post his Liverpool journey, threw his hat into the ring following the resignation of Julian Nagelsmann. “This is the highlight of my career, and I will give all I have got in order to be successful,” said Klopp. “I am far from perfect. I want to look at the most successful Germany coaches who developed the team.”

In his very first interaction, Klopp sounded a warning to the German media, stressing that he would call it quits if his family was not left in peace. “If you behave badly, I will be gone. I am not doing this job for myself, I am doing this for you. I am taking this job even though I saw how you treated Julian and Thomas Tuchel,” he said.

The pessimists in the media contingent may even silently pray for his downfall, but the 59-year-old will fight all odds during the rebuild to restore

Germany’s pride.

Another team craving for success at the elite level is Portugal, which has given the keys to veteran Jorge Jesus. The man he succeeds, Roberto Martinez, simply could not extract the best out of a squad decorated with talent of the highest order.

As Portugal prepares for the inevitable post-Cristiano Ronaldo era and a World Cup on home soil – it will host the next showpiece with five other nations – Jesus has an opportunity to leave an imprint on the country’s football history.

There is, however, no clarity on when the 41-year-old Ronaldo will bring down the curtain on a stellar international career. “Both of us will have a conversation about what Cristiano wants to do. I know that he wants to keep playing for Al-Nassr. I have not spoken to him yet. As long as he is playing and is in a condition to be selected, I will pick him... there are certain limits and conditions that I consider best for the National team,” Jesus said.

If he manages to stay in the job until the WC, he could well be the oldest chief coach in that edition (at 75 years). Jesus does not have age on his side, but that never stops him from brimming with excitement and passion at work.

“Age does not matter. I am 71 (at the time of speaking, he is 72 now), but I feel like I am 50 years old because I am healthy. I train every day, for an hour or two. It is going to be a tough challenge (emerging victorious in the global event), but I am convinced that we will win.”

Former Croatia manager Zlatko Dalic twice came within touching distance of lifting the coveted trophy despite not having the richest of resources – the European side finished runner-up in 2018 and took home the bronze medal four years later.

Dalic bid adieu after Croatia was knocked out of the recent WC in the round of 32, making way for Slaven Bilic to steer the team in a new direction. Bilic

is bracing for his second spell with the Croatian side, having coached it between 2006 and 2012.

“I am more mature and experienced than I was in 2006. But I have the same motivation and desire to see Croatia stay powerful, bold and successful. I am genuinely happy to start this challenge, and I am fully prepared for it,” Bilic said.

Also beginning a new adventure is Belgium boss Mark van Bommel, who takes over from Rudi Garcia. With Romelu Lukaku likely to be the only man standing from the so-called ‘golden generation’, the former Netherlands player will have many areas to address.

“Belgium has outstanding players and enormous potential. We want to build a team that is disciplined, ambitious and brave enough to compete with the very best,” van Bommel said. Who are among the best in the years to come remains to be seen.



THE GIST

Zidane has finally landed his dream job after years of wait, and now has the near-impossible task of bettering or matching his predecessor Deschamps’ outstanding managerial record

Mancini, who was not the first choice, will hope to take Italy back to a stage it ruled quite a few times. The country has hit an all-time low of not qualifying for the last three World Cups

Klopp, too, has taken up an ultra-challenging project with Germany, which is nowhere close to being the winning machine it once was and exited early in each of the last three editions

Portugal, co-host of the next showpiece with five other nations, prepares for the inevitable post-Ronaldo era and has handed the keys to veteran Jesus

Bilic, bracing for a second spell with Croatia, will look to steer the team in a new direction after it came close twice to winning the biggest prize of them all

Zidane will inherit a richly talented squad that was put together by Deschamps, a master who oversaw multiple transitions in the national team. Excited by the prospect of coaching an “extraordinary” bunch, he began “dreaming” the day he officially took over as the boss

SpaceX rocket stage hurtles toward moon, astronomers hot on its trail

This Falcon 9 rocket had launched two satellites towards the moon in January 2025, then SpaceX abandoned the rocket's spent upper stage in an unstable orbit as it lacked enough fuel to return to the earth or head into deep space; it is now expected to hit the moon at 12:05 p.m. IST on August 5

Shreejaya Karantha

Astronomers are closely monitoring a SpaceX rocket stage that is on the way to striking the moon. This Falcon 9 rocket had launched two satellites towards the moon in January 2025. Then SpaceX abandoned the rocket's spent upper stage in an unstable orbit as it lacked enough fuel to return to the earth or head into deep space. It is now expected to hit the moon at 12:05 p.m. IST on August 5.

The independent astronomer Bill Gray's calculations showed that the rocket stage is en route to the Einstein Crater on the moon. Mr. Gray said that over the course of a year, any small changes could add up and cause the object to fly close to the moon instead of impacting it. So he gathered more data, with which by January 2026 he was 100% sure that the stage was on a collision course.

"By April, I was confident enough to announce that it would hit near the Einstein crater," he said, giving scientists roughly 3.5 months to plan observations. All details regarding this event are posted on his website, 'Project Pluto'.

Since he had tracked the rocket within days of its launch, identifying the debris was easy: "We were somewhat fortunate in this case. If an object isn't spotted until months or years after launch, identifying it can be quite challenging," Mr. Gray said.

Accidental opportunity

Rather than threaten astronomy studies, experts said the collision will be an opportunity to study what happens in such events. Specifically, artificial impacts like this are rare. They are also valuable because scientists already know the impactor's mass, speed, and size in advance, unlike with natural meteoroid strikes, rendering the collision a so-called controlled source event.

The last time a similar event was observed was NASA's 2009 LCROSS mission, which deliberately crashed a rocket stage near the moon's south pole and confirmed water ice in the debris it kicked up.

What to expect

Mr. Gray has estimated the impact speed to be at 8,700 km/hr. During the time of the collision, astronomers are planning to investigate the behaviour of lunar dust, which can reveal more about the consequences of natural impacts and seismic activity. Since dust on the moon is not the same as dust anywhere on the earth, astronomers can also benefit from knowing how long dust will remain suspended or what kind of dust storms may be expected if humans want to start living on the moon.



The Falcon 9 rocket whose upper stage is going to crash on the moon (right) and the location of Einstein crater on the moon. NASA AND MAGERE HEIN (CC BY-SA)

According to a paper by U.S. Los Alamos National Laboratory planetary scientist Benjamin Fernando and colleagues (uploaded to the arXiv preprint server on July 16), three particular effects are expected from the impact.

First is a flash of light at the moment of impact, which may last less than a second. This is produced by material from the rocket stage vaporising on contact with the moon. Second, a cloud of debris or ejecta, possibly vapour, will be thrown up. Finally, a crater 20-30 m across, estimated based on past impacts and computer models.

The researchers wrote in their paper that "a double crater may be produced" if the object breaks apart, "which may occur depending on the stage's attitude at the time of impact".

However, catching the flash won't be easy because it will be on the moon's sunlit side, and any attempt will require a telescope.

Observers in India also won't get a chance to see it live as the impact will happen at noon, with the moon below the horizon then.

What if...?

According to Mr. Gray, current estimates of the impact time and location carry an uncertainty of about 5 seconds in impact time and roughly 20 km in location.

Einstein crater sits at 88° W, 15° N, close to the western edge of the near side. It is far from the equatorial and south-polar

With space agencies and private companies both targeting the moon for long-term lunar bases, mining, and satellites, accidental interference between missions may arise. Lunar scientific and cultural heritage are also at risk

regions, where most current and planned lunar landings are concentrated. So the chances of the rocket stage altering any sites that spacefaring nations consider significant are low.

Hypothetically, if this rocket stage or any other debris happened to strike any significant location on the moon – such as the Shiv Shakti point where Chandrayaan-3 landed – there currently is no legal instrument to protect them.

"There is no legal claim," Ranjana Kaul, partner at Dua Associates & Vice President, International Institute of Space Law, Paris, said. "Our outer space treaty does not recognise sovereignty in outer space." She added that just because a country happened to land at a site, it doesn't own that piece of the moon under current regulations.

Moon as a laboratory

Dr. Kaul also stressed the importance of studying artificial impacts like this one because of how quickly activity on the moon is expanding. With space agencies and private companies both targeting the

moon for long-term lunar bases, mining, and satellites, accidental interference between missions may arise. Lunar scientific and cultural heritage are also at risk. "Debris regulation is a serious problem," Dr. Kaul added.

At the United Nations, the Action Team on Lunar Activity Consultation (ATLAC) working group is trying to build consensus among spacefaring nations on issues from coordinating on landing sites to lunar dust mitigation and debris rules – which is a scenario the impending impact previews.

The UN discussions will nonetheless take time to come up with new rules

"In the United Nations, decisions are by consensus," Dr. Kaul said. This means all participating countries must agree before a proposal becomes binding international regulation, a process that can take years.

Mr. Gray also said space agencies handle leftover rocket stages differently. NASA and the European Space Agency, he said, have been careful. The upper stage that launched the Webb telescope, for instance, was placed in an orbit that will keep it away from the earth-moon system for roughly a century. China's recent stages have similarly been directed toward the Pacific Ocean or orbits around the Sun.

SpaceX has made no public statement on its disposal policy, however.

(Shreejaya Karantha is a freelance science writer. shreejayakaranth@gmail.com)

THE GIST

Astronomers are closely monitoring a SpaceX rocket stage that is on the way to striking the moon

Experts said the collision will be an opportunity to study what happens in such events. Specifically, artificial impacts like this are rare

Astronomers are planning to investigate the behaviour of lunar dust, which can reveal more about the consequences of natural impacts and seismic activity

BIG SHOT



A fish farmer sets up shade cloths over his fish farm to protect the fish from intense sunlight amid a heatwave warning, at sea off Tongyeong, South Korea on August 4. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Global warming: picking speed

Vasudevan Mukunth

A new study published in *Geophysical Research Letters* has reported evidence that global warming is speeding up.

In the past, it was difficult for scientists to prove warming was accelerating because global temperatures are noisy, meaning they fluctuate year to year due to natural factors like volcanic eruptions and changes in solar activity.

Such events can also temporarily mask the underlying human-caused temperature trend.

To sidestep this issue, the study's authors analysed five major global temperature datasets and used statistical methods to subtract the influence of these factors.

Once this noise was removed, the authors found that the rate of warming had jumped. They also wrote that they were more than 98% certain that this jump was real rather than a random, short-lived fluctuation.

Specifically, they reported that the earth has warmed faster over the last decade than during any previous decade on record, with the change beginning around 2015.

Under the previous, slower warming rate, scientists had hoped that the world would have more time to keep global warming under 1.5 degrees Celsius. However, under the new accelerated pace, the earth will breach 1.5 degrees Celsius of warming by 2030.



A helicopter conducting night operations prepares to drop water on the Quilpituk Creek wildfire burning on the west side of Okanagan Lake near Fintny, British Columbia on August 3. THE CANADIAN PRESS

While greenhouse gas emissions are the primary cause, the study noted that a drop in air pollution may be a contributing factor.

Historically, certain pollutants called aerosols had a cooling effect as they reflected sunlight. As the air got cleaner, the cooling mask disappeared, allowing the full force of global warming to be felt.

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